VOICES OF GOD'S SERVANTS

AN INQUIRY INTO THE BURDENS & VISIONS OF GOD'S SERVANTS AT THE BEGINNING OF THE TWENTY-FIRST CENTURY

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INTRODUCTION

This book is a collection of reports of the 21st century realities and dreams of God's servants. These reports were made during the Evangelizing Our World Inquiry (World Inquiry) conducted during the three years leading up to the 2004 Forum for World Evangelization.

The World Inquiry was a quest to know the mind of God through the burdens, visions and dreams of his people as we move into the future. In most of the inquiry events held, a Christian leader had given some thought to this in advance and many completed a draft to present and then be refined during the event (see meta narrative form used in Appendix A). Selected reports from the events have been organized by continent and are included in this compendium.

Thanks to so many Christian leaders around the world, who gave sacrificially of their time and resources that enabled the extent, depth and results/findings of the Inquiry process conducted. Praise God for his provision!

In an earlier written communication to prospective participants in one country, Paul McKaughan expressed what the World Inquiry is and what it is not. Portions of his letter are shown below as an introduction to aid our understanding of the content of this compendium and how it fits into the preliminary findings of the inquiry.

Luis Bush
September 2, 2004

What the World Inquiry was and What it was not

The inquiry started out as a modest exercise to probe the minds and hearts of Evangelical leaders in the major cities of the world. The premise that gave impetus to the process was very simple. It was felt that if one could get some sense of what God was saying to his people through their aspirations, prayer burdens and visions for their ministries, one would have an indication of what God wanted them to do in the future. The Scriptures seem to indicate that one of the ways God leads is through our desires and aspirations when we submit our selves completely to him.

The Inquiry was born out of a simple desire to hear what God was saying to his people. We wanted especially to hear those voices and leaders who are now emerging onto their national, regional and international scenes. These are the people who will minister during the next 10-20 years of the 21st Century. The Inquiry was not seen as a rigorous, methodologically driven research project, but rather a humble desire to hear God's voice through his people.

However, just as we started the Inquiry to listen to God's people, if we continue to listen to God and to one another, we can be sure our Father will be glorified as his kingdom work extended.

In Christ,

Paul McKaughan, President
The Evangelical Fellowship of Mission Agencies in the USA

THE BURDENS AND VISIONS: AN OVERVIEW

Sang-Bok David Kim

As the world entered the 21st century, evangelical leaders have been interested in seeking the direction of world evangelization, which the Lord had left with His followers to fulfill prior to His Second Coming. Jesus said to His disciples, "The Gospel of Kingdom shall be preached in all the world as a witness to all nations and then the end will come" (Matt 24:14). For the last two thousand years, the church of Jesus Christ sought to fulfill His mandate to hasten the coming of His kingdom on earth. A quantitative and qualitative survey involving some 6,500 Christian leaders from 850 cities meeting in 111 different venues around the world, started in the United States, then Asia, Europe, Africa, Latin America, during the period of two years, ending with one week of the World Inquiry International Coalition at Samsung Human Center, Bundang, Korea in June, 2002. One hundred sixty delegates came together from all continents to evaluate some observations and tentative conclusions of the World Inquiry and to discuss and debate on the findings. Useful discussions were exchanged among the delegates in groups. Many suggestions were made and helpful criticisms were offered. All the discussions were recorded and at the end of the consultation the materials were turned over for Luis Bush, WI international director, who initiated the Inquiry with cooperation of the faculty of Fuller Theological Seminary, to refine the findings with the fruits of consultation to produce the final reports for 2004 Forum for World Evangelization at Pattaya, Thailand in September 28-October 3, 2004. The current volume is one of the six books which hold the final reports on the minds and hearts of the Christian leaders around the world through their burdens, vision and dreams they shared with one another regarding world evangelization in the 21st century.

Since the detailed reports are included in this volume, I see no reason to reinvent the wheel, except highlighting some of the main concerns of each continent and some common denominators for an overview which have been placed by God on the participants.

The Gospel with Bread

In Africa, some parts of Asia and Latin America, social and physical needs are acute as spiritual needs, which are heavily on the hearts of the regional leaders. In Africa, illiteracy, poverty, HIV/AIDS demanded the serious attention of the local servants of God and further from the church worldwide. Division within the church, voice on moral issues, women in missionary work, unreached people, lack of training leaders are the other burdens. Some hopeful signs were observed as the

leaders saw the urgent need of prayer network and intensifying prayer efforts to work together for the common task of identifying and reaching the unreached in their regions, such groups as Malinke, Fulani, Pygmy, Wolof, and Soninke. Outreach to children and youth is one of the major concerns. In D. R. Congo people are under suffering in everything including school, hospitals, sleeping sickness, roads, suffering not due to laziness. The Gospel must come to the suffering people, but social and physical needs must be cared for at the same time to open their hearts to the Gospel, which require concerted efforts of the Christian community worldwide. The Gospel with bread is the ministry God is expecting His church to pursue.

Growing Churches under Persecution

The churches in Asia are growing everywhere and visions and dream of the Asian church leaders are expanding and being realized. The churches in China are granted unlimited opportunities for outreach in spite of the persecutions from the communist government. Three self churches as well as house churches are growing in leaps and bounds along with their unprecedented economic growth, just as Korea has once experienced in the two decades of 1970's and 80's. Church growth and economic growth went hand in hand in Korea. Chinese Church is becoming now one of the largest churches in the world. Someone quipped, "The Holy Spirit must have moved from Korea to China." Chinese Christian leaders at home and abroad are eyeing on the Back to Jerusalem Movement, which is also called the Silk Road missions. There is a strong desire among the Chinese Christians that they will dedicate themselves to world evangelization. There is still conflict and mistrust between Three-Self government approved churches and underground house churches, which are experiencing unbelievable growth even under persecution. Chinese leaders see a day when the army of Chinese missionaries marches out for the Gospel in the 21st century, who will involve themselves not only for the evangelization of China but also the Moslem nations along the Silk Road to Jerusalem. They are not praying for either the Three Self churches or the house churches alone, but for the church of Jesus Christ which will be a missionary church for world evangelization.

Do It Again, Lord!

Korean churches have experienced a rapid growth, once a mission field only a few decades ago now an active missionary nation for world evangelization with 13,000 missionaries to 150 nations around the world in such a short period of time since 1988, second to the United States in missions. Church grew in 1970's-80's. Twenty three of the fifty largest churches in the world are found in Korea. Every two years Mission Korea Conference sees two thousands of university students

dedicating themselves for world missions out of six thousands who are gathered. Korean churches are not able to sufficiently processing the candidates. Yet on the other side church growth significantly slowed down to 1% in contrast to 11.5% in earlier days. As church growth slowed down, economic growth also slowed down. However, missionary movement increased. The WI surveys revealed a great concern on lack of leadership, lack of vision, lack of cooperation, not lack of volunteer for ministry. The younger church leaders of rising generation are calling for a fresh revival aiming for 2007, the 100th anniversary of 1907 revival in North Korea, which ignited the church in Korea. Networking is going on and a fresh prayer movement is attempted. Lord, do it again in Korea.

Open Door on the Silk Road

On the way to Jerusalem lie Turkic speaking Islamic countries, which became independent from the former Soviet Union in 1991 and where the Holy Spirit is leading a church growth movement. It is simply amazing to watch churches springing up all over the Silk Road still small but steadily growing. In 2002 one hundred eighty Turkic speaking pastors gathered in Almaty from the young churches of nine countries, Kazak, Uzbek, Kyrgyz, Uigur, Karakalpak, Tajik, Turkmen, Azeri, and Turks. Nine out of ten of 180 Turkic speaking pastors present at the consultation were converted since the collapse of the Soviet Union in 1991. The churches in China and the churches on Silk Road in Islamic countries are both growing. The Holy Spirit is doing a new thing in theses regions as He did in the book of Acts in a similar fashion.

In both regions of China and Central Asia one of the noteworthy ministries is to produce sound biblical principles of good citizenship for the Church in Communist China and the churches in the Islamic countries, which will manifest the good citizenship of Christians and the high moral lifestyle to the suspecting Communist and Islamic governments. Social needs of young boys, prisoners, and orphan boys should be met and church plant experts are greatly needed for the outreach of the Silk Road countries to reach back to Jerusalem with the Gospel, where the evangelical movement started twenty centuries ago.

According to Evangelical Fellowship of India, the churches in South Asia are confronted with religious fundamentalism of Hindu, Buddhism and Moslem, pluralism, persecution and injustice. However, a large number is coming to Christ as the fruits of hard work and fervent prayers during the last decade. Prayer networks are formed for evangelization of India. Social transformation is a major interest among the Christians. Leadership development is far behind the growth of the churches and

is in a great need. Social problems are also so great that resource networking must be initiated locally and worldwide by all means.

The Chandigarh region is in need of prayer, cooperative action, empowerment through information and its communication, Bible teaching, the sharing of their stories, aim impacting the city in the areas of lifestyles, reconciliation, social justice, and economic sufficiency. The Gospel must impact the people in the totality of their life.

Chinnai is pursuing transformation under the motto of "Working Together towards a Transformed Chinnai." In India the watchword is transformation. Chinnai is burdened with many social problems such as suicides, premarital sex, organized crime, while color crimes, HIV/AIDS, elder abuse, runaway girls, child sex, crimes against women, rising divorce rate, and smuggling. Transformation through the Gospel of Jesus Christ is in a great need.

The leaders of the city of Hudhiana strongly feel the need of united prayer initiative to see a total transformation of the city to plant 1000 churches by 2005. Their watchword is "The power, the presence and the peace of God for all." All night prayer vigil is going on, and people are volunteering for prayer with 24 hours sign up sheets, doing spiritual mapping of the city, praying for the transformation of each ward.

In Australia, 70% of population claim to believe in God, but only 10% attend church. Outreach to non Christian background is a major emphasis in a number of denominations, including Anglicans.

Evangelical Churches Still Growing

Europe is facing the challenges of Post-modern era, confronted with difficulties of reaching children, young people, Gen Xers, 5% annual decrease of church attendance in UK, where tolerance is the cardinal virtue in the spirit of pluralism and any form of exclusivity frowned upon. Christian leaders see the need of the church to seek societal transformation through Christian influence. However, like a woman who is about to give birth with no strength to deliver, churches appear to have insufficient strength to deliver.

Alpha course is widely offered for outreach in small groups, and many Christian politicians are open to impact the nation for Christ. Churches have a vision of societal transformation through a Movement of Change, challenging church members to be agents for change. Prayer Points are organized to move forward for the transformation of the country. There is a sense of certain defeatism observed among the Christians feeling that churches have no coherent message, too concerned about individualistic integrity as a successful church rather than about

listening to what the world thinks of them, watching the failures of families, failing to reach children, youth and ethnic minority among them. The hidden faces need empowerment. They feel they are stuck in a rut, marginalized and not realizing, not in contact with outsiders. The church leaders feel the church needs a fresh touch of the Holy Spirit for new strength to carry out the Great Commission.

In the city of Essen, Germany, people see the rapid growth of Islamic religion, which has 12 mosques. Among the Christians they hold monthly united prayers and rejoice in the spiritual awakening among the youth and new visible citywide activities, YOU fare, Pray2Move, Alliance Youth prayer event, Youth prayer and mobilization movement, outreach to immigrants. For the last ten years unite prayers have been conducted and now they see the fruits. They are thankful for a spiritual atmosphere of unity, joy and hope.

In Norway, NORME is a priority focus on evangelization and missions, churches and missions together, no longer two separate movements, but one conjoined. Churches and missions are able to work together. European Evangelical Alliance enjoys a new day of a stream of God-activity in a new day in their part of the world in both a new century and millennium. Free churches are a positive challenge to the state church, inspiring a renewal of congregation building and evangelizing consciousness. A cross denominational network is emerging as a positive response to the challenges. Alpha courses, a church growth movement with Christian A Schwartz and ministry of Willow Creek Association enhance their evangelizing and community building. Currently 4-5% attends church regularly, but young generations up to 30%. They are not interested in traditional church structures, but are generating an opportunity for revival in the country.

In Bulgaria churches are growing. They have 1,530 churches and 130,000 members, collaborative consortium praying together, Christian literatures, Jesus film, Bulgarian Evangelical Alliance. In the city of Sofia they see 1,000 churches in 5 minutes walking distance from the house of each inhabitant of the city. Churches launched Missionary Movement for the Spiritual and Political Liberation on March 26, 2002. A new exuberance is observed with an initiative for society, distributing 16,000 packages for social care ministries and the Friendship Run.

O Come, Mighty Spirit!

In South America, Argentina also feels like the woman ready to give birth but no strength to deliver them. They are seeking a visitation of the Holy Spirit to ignite a fresh commitment to the Lord Jesus Christ and His Gospel. 1,500 key pastors gathered together to renew their vision for

the Body of Christ through evangelization and discipleship, church planting, home and foreign missions, care programs, theological education, penetration of society including the political arena. Christians 25 to 30% of the populations pray for the Christian impact on the nation to rise.

In Quito, Ecuador, 1,800 national pastors met and prayed or evangelization and missions, discipleship and responsibility, Christian services for the poor, the dispossessed families, children, youth, elderly and ethnic peoples, transformational leadership, crying for ethical values and morals in the midst of increasing corruption at all levels, evangelical unity and identity.

In some parts of the world churches appear to be weakened, while in other regions churches are growing. Whether strong or weak, evangelical leaders everywhere are determined to obey the Lord's command by all means to bring all nations to Christ, disciple them, teach them to observe to do all things He taught, personal, social, national and world transformation through the power of the Gospel, united prayer and the power of the Holy Spirit. Evangelical churches are still growing all over the world. In this century evangelicals everywhere have one thing in common, earnestly praying for a fresh touch of the Holy Spirit and the fulfillment of the prophecy of Jesus in Matthew 24:14. Amen!

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21ST CENTURY REALITIES AND THE DREAMS OF GOD'S SERVANTS

AFRICA

A NEW DAWN ON THE MISSIONARY MOVEMENT IN FRANCOPHONE AFRICA (CRAF)

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The sun has set on CRAF 2002 and a new dawn is rising on the missionary movement in Francophone Africa. Luis Bush concluded with this image the presentation of the results of an inquiry he made during CRAF 2002. Another participant compared CRAF to a fan God uses to maintain and increase the flame of the missionary movement and the development of strategic partnerships for the un-reached People in Francophone Africa. By God's grace, the Francophone Africa Regional Consultation (CRAF 2002) was held from May 5th to 11th, 2002 in Grand Bassam, Côte d'Ivoire.

About 353 participants from 16 Sub-Saharan Francophone African Countries, 6 Anglophone African Countries, France, Belgium, Canada, England, New Zealand, Guatemala and USA participated in CRAF 2002. These were key leaders who represented an important group of churches, missionary agencies and other Christian organizations. This consultation, the third of its kind, follows Dakar 98 and BASSAM 2000.

Beyond its experiential side, CRAF is important on several accounts. It demonstrates that the Church in Francophone Africa is conscious of its missionary responsibility towards the unreached People of the continent and the world evangelization; and that it plans to face the situation. It also demonstrates that the Church wants to expend all the efforts to the accomplishment of its major role: win the unreached people of the region and contribute in a significant way to the world evangelization. At this moment in time where most unreached people seem to be more resistant to the Gospel than ever, where the necessity for the Church to demonstrate its unity and work together is evident, CRAF finally demonstrates that the Church in Francophone Africa has decided to put all the advantages on its side working through strategic partnerships to be more effective.

CRAF 2002 focused on the un-reached people and the identification of what God is doing in Western and Central Francophone Africa. The idea was to build on the results of BASSAM 2000. Many participants said that God used CRAF 2002 to talk to them… The following main points represent a brief summary of what took place and what theses participants indicated as being more strategic and more inspired.

Plenary Sessions

Edifying and challenging plenary sessions were highly appreciated; the question among others was: the state and the challenges of the un-reached people in Francophone Africa, the initiatives and efforts of cooperation, of reconciliation, of member care, of the national missionary training and sending, of HIV/AIDS and of the contribution of women in the missionary work.

There were edifying reports of what God is doing through some partnership efforts, some National Initiative efforts in certain countries throughout West and Central Africa.

A sounding on the state of evangelization in the region was taken by Luis Bush. The results brought out very interesting information on challenges, opportunities and obstacles, etc. that the Church in Francophone Africa faces today.

Forums and Workshops

Working groups were formed and worked 3 days on various subjects: National Strategy and Research; Radio; Translation/Literature/Audio; Edition/Publication, Mission: Mobilization, Training and Sending National Missionaries; Prayer and Advocacy; Mission to Muslims; Social Ministries; Women in Mission; Ministry to Children; Leadership Development in Africa; HIV/AIDS; Sport; Member Care; and Urban Ministry.

A special time was devoted to specific un-reached People considered as strategic. Theses groups are the following: Fulani; Malinke; Wolof and Pygmy. There was also a time for country meetings.

The time for final reports of all these different forums and workshops gave the following feelings and results:

1) God is at work mobilizing the Church in Francophone Africa to finish the task of reaching the un-reached people in the region and beyond.
2) An extraordinary missionary potential exists in the Church in Francophone Africa, which only needs to be mobilized, trained and sent.
3) The remaining task is big, both by its importance and its complexity.
4) There was a commitment to continue mobilizing all the resources in Francophone Africa (as well as human, material and organizational) in order to accomplish the task of reaching the people left to be reached in this region, through a group work in a tight cooperation and partnership efforts.

5) The desire to equip Christians in Francophone Africa to fully enter their role in order to accomplish this task, either women, young people, church leaders, denominations, or mission agencies, has clearly been expressed throughout the whole consultation.

The following decisions represent part of the results easy to measure to this consultation:

1) For each forum and workshop, it was decided to develop a regional network or a partnership where it does not exist yet. The facilitators have been designated.
2) The holding of National and Sub-regional Consultations which targets the un-reached people groups: Senegal (May 27-31, 2002); Central African Republic (October 21-24, 2002); Togo (October 28 - November 1, 2002); Lake Chad Basin (October 20-25, 2003); etc.
3) The decision to develop international networks among national partnerships which are developing for people groups or ministries: Malinke, Fulani, Pygmy, Wolof, Soninke, Ministry to children, AIDS, Evangelical Ministries of Radio, etc. The main Coordinators have been designated for each group.
4) The effective contribution of women in the missionary task was recognized and affirmed. To that effect, since Bassam 2000, two women are members of the CRAF steering committee.

Follow Up

In order to enable these initiatives to develop and to motivate us more to work in the direction of these conclusions, the steering committee will take care in particular of the follow up of CRAF 2002.

Moreover, the participants made a commitment to meet again in 2 years time for another consultation. This will enable the working groups to meet again and evaluate their progress.

Conclusion

Our wish is to see CRAF making a real contribution to the accomplishment of the task of winning all the people groups in Francophone African and beyond to Christ!

We want to glorify God by working to the establishment of His Kingdom in the midst of each people group.

To that effect, CRAF will continue to:

- Provide a large platform where the key church leaders in Francophone Africa can meet with the key leaders of mission agencies and specialized ministries in the region to develop projects for regional and national efforts of cooperation in order to reach the un-reached people left in Francophone Africa and beyond.
- Mobilize the Church in Francophone Africa for its missionary responsibility towards the un-reached people.
- Encourage the reconciliation among the different parts of the Body of Christ, without which, there can't be any confidence, unity, collaboration or blessing of God.
- Intensify the prayer efforts for the un-reached people.
- Stimulate a better research for the un-reached people in each country in order to obtain accurate information which will serve as a base, and a motivation for the sending of both African and expatriate missionaries.
- Face the need of training and sending of African national missionaries.
- Introduce new resources which will be suitably integrated in the existing efforts of evangelization and church planting in order to reach these objectives.

CRAF 2002 was a blessed time for all on several accounts: renewal and refreshing for the ministry, a larger understanding of what God is doing, a broadening of the vision for God's work, the development of a positive cooperate spirit, the development of relationships with ministry in mind; encouragement, etc. The consultation ended with the sharing of the Holy Communion together. This clearly demonstrated the spirit of the consultation as well as the continuous commitment among participants.

VERITABLE SURVIVORS: A TESTIMONY OF THE PEOPLE IN THE D.R. CONGO

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Introduction:

In Congo, as a result of the war, the Ubangi region, which used to be the hub of economic activity, has become isolated. Now, people in the Ubangi region depend more on Bangui, Central African Republic for getting goods than any other places. Bangui has become now an economic center where farm products are sold and goods are bought to sell to villagers in the surrounding neighborhoods. Basic family needs have become a real challenge. In order for parents to afford sending their children to school, a rescue project must be established to provide some resources to people in the rural areas so they have something to live on.

I. The Context of the World Inquiries Conducted In Congo

THE DEPTH OF SUFFERING

A lot of people do not have clothes to wear and these prefer to stay in the jungle for fear that people will laugh at them when they come out. Some of them are obliged to share one piece of cloth with the entire family. They called it “Moko Yoane” which means “First John.” This expression means that one person will use the cloth when he or she wants to go to the market to sell snacks, or buy food while his or her relatives wait their turn at home to wear the same cloth.

People live in darkness. There is no way they can afford to buy kerosene for their lamps. What they do is to make light out of an unripe papaya fruit. They cut one side of the papaya fruit, pull out the seeds and put in palm oil. They usually dump in the oil a piece of charcoal or an old piece of cotton cloth. The palm oil in the papaya fruit serves as fuel to the charcoal in order to produce light. This awesome technology is birthed out of a chaotic situation. This method of producing light is an invaluable asset during funeral ceremonies because since most of funerals are traditionally held at night.

People work regularly without being paid, and there were instances where they have not been paid for more than eleven months or more. The reason why they continue to work is because they do not want to loose their

jobs. They had hoped that things will get better soon, but it has been five years already and they do not see any sign of social, economic or political improvement. Many who hung on to hope have died two or three years ago without being rewarded for their hard labor. Several are no doubt still working like that in the Congo in order to keep their jobs and a way to keep their honor and dignity.

Schools are no more like during the colonial period. Children now write on their logs because most school benches were looted. Teachers themselves, who have not been paid for several years, teach for free. Some of them have initiated a way to survive this difficult condition. Children have become source of labor for teachers. They enjoy helping teachers to clear their gardens so that teachers could be happy to teach them.

Hospitals are no longer equipped and it is even difficult to get basic medication for headache. Although medicines are well subsidized, people are still not able to afford hospital bills. Many of them come to hospital too late when they are already in a critical condition or they have tried traditional medicines without success, or they have consulted charismatic religious healers without success. Hospital bills have become a threat and so people leave the hospital before the nurse brings in the bill.

People are dying from sleeping sickness because Congo never produces any medicine to help fight against it. Prescription drugs usually come from Belgium. Hospitals lack mattresses and bed sheets. Patients bring their own blanket, bed-sheets and towels. A UN report on September 9, 2002 praised Covenant Hospital at Karawa for the coordination of Humanitarian Affairs. It reports that on an inter-agency mission to four Congolese sites from July 15-19, the Covenant hospital cooperated with non-government organizations to help patients in the fight against HIV/AIDS virus and other diseases (http://www.covchurch.org/cov/news/item2336.html). The report continues to underline the hard work and support of the Covenant Church and other Protestant groups in the region. Nurses and doctors work hard in order to bring relief to patients but extensive preliminary care should be taken care in order to create conditions conducive for fighting the disease.

In spite of their ability to diagnose ailments, African doctors lack the equipments to test patients before prescribing medication. There is no way medical doctors could wait for the results of a test because so often they are tired attending to long list of patients.

Roads are no longer motorable. They have become paths that lead people to their gardens. The colonial building is no longer a historic place but a dwelling place for mosquitoes and tsetse flies. The only alternative to using road routes is to travel by airplane. But, the airplane may cost between 300 to 400 US dollars, which may be a fortune for a person who has not been paid for years and also for someone who is surviving for all he or she is doing. The main question is how many airplanes are in circulation besides public transportation?

To find a solution to the terrible transportation situation, the Congolese have created an appropriate and sophisticated technology. There is the "taxi-bicycle" called "Toleka" which means, "Let's go!" made by people of the city of Bumba. It serves as a comfortable option and means of transportation because the roads and bridges have become immotorable. Young children are trained to transport passengers by bike for more than 450 miles. Some of the pastors were able to attend the summer mission conference because of this new and appropriate technology. They paid these young riders four US dollars for their transportation. These bikes are able to transport travelers and their luggage for about 85 to 100 miles a day. It took them about six days from Bumba to Gbadolite (445 miles) on the "Toleka" taxi-bike. We thank God for allowing these people to provide this transportation. These young children, however, need assistance so that they can continue their ministry of conveying people from one place to the other. This is a one-on-one ministry of proclaiming the Good News to the group of riders.

Their sufferings are obviously, not due to laziness. Some of them walk hundreds of miles to sell peanuts in order to buy a T-shirt but they may end up buying only salt. Many still have tons of coffee from their plantation in storage. There is no one to buy them. The people desire peace but neither they neither see peace restored nor their children having access to

better education.

Though everything does not work well, God is always in control and can bless people with special wisdom to deal with the circumstance. The D.R. Congo, the non-Christians are going to church, worshiping the God they never worshiped before. Many have been converted to Christianity and would set apart a particular time for fast and prayer. Though, their worship is characterized by loud prayers causing others to think that the God they are worshiping is too far away from them, they are able to express themselves that it is God who sustains them from this situation. It is God who provides for them. Knowing God in this context is experiencing God in daily living.

The challenge facing leaders in the DR Congo is that of rebuilding what has been destroyed; it is a challenge of bringing people to hang on hope for the future; it is a challenge of educating Christians and nationalists to over look their own concerns in order to seek for a common interest and it is a challenge of resolving the spiritual, ethnic and physical problems of the people.

Businessmen, teachers, nurses and medical doctors, engineers, builders, electricians, accountants, politicians, economists, sociologists, missionaries, pastors, farmers and any body who reads this article and is able to empathize with the above situation is invited to give advice as to what could be done to bring relief to the sufferings of these people and to enable these survivors to continue to hope for the best in the future. If we are able to jump-start order into this chaotic situation the people, they (survivors) will work for their future. “Enabling someone to walk for five yards is giving all the possibility for that person to go 5,000 miles.” So empowering or rescuing someone to live for one day is opening ways for that person to have long life and to give to that person a chance to hear the word of God.

II. The World Inquiry in Congo and the Central African Republic

It was in this context that the World Inquiry was conducted in Gbadolite, Karawa, and Gemena of the D.R. Congo and in Bangui, capital city of Central African Republic.

A. City: Gemena, D.R. Congo

Date: August 9, 2002
Participants: 43 from 9 different denominations in Gemena
Local Facilitator: Rev. Luyada Gbuda
Secretary: Rev. Gonenze Enzewuda
Sponsored by: The Evangelical Free and Covenant Church of Congo

People took so long to discuss the document of World Inquiry in the way some did not want to join the opening session until they have finished with their work. As they gathered in plenary session, they brought up 6 elements that are obstacles for the World evangelization:

1. War: They discussed the impact or consequences of war over Church activities and denounced it as a big problem for blocking any initiative to advance the Church activities.
2. The Globalization: This was a subject they wanted to learn as the term was not well known
3. Poverty: They were discussing the way they could do to end with poverty because many people do not want to go to Church because they do not have clothes, they do not have enough food, and they do not have money to purchase any thing they wanted.
4. The Lack of Training leaders becomes an other issue for world evangelization
5. Analphabetism or Illiteracy is a major problem for people in rural areas.
6. Ethnic Conflict or tribal division and ecclesiastical division based on doctrine have become major problems in communication. People are specious to everybody and it is blocking any Church initiative to launch mission movement.

After this hot discussion, they have decided to wait for the result of World Inquiry in order to confirm what they were concern about and seek for further resolution.

B. Karawa, D.R. Congo
   Date: August 11, 2002
   Participants: 35
   Local Facilitator: Rev. Luyada Gbuda
   Secretary: Rev. Duale Langba
   Sponsored by: The Evangelical Covenant Church of Congo or Evangelical Community in the Ubangi-Mongala regions.

All participants discussed for so long the following topics:

1. Ethnic Tension: Is gaining dramatically place in the Church after shredding country into several factions. The aim of the discussion was how to better resolve ethnic tensions.
2. Poverty: All were so concern on how to end with poverty that is devastating lives of children as well as adults.
3. Analphabetism: Still more women and man in remote villages who do not read and write
4. Division within the Church: Leaders are more involved in this kind of problems and are causing problems to plan together how to reach out to un-reached people
5. The Term Globalization: The term was wrongly translated in French that confused them a bit (mondialization).
6. The Lack of interest in Christian faith because of all is happening within the Church that involves Christians.

Some suggestions were made in terms of length of time to conduct the world Inquiry. The time was not enough to do such a careful analysis of all the issues included in the document. Questions were not well formulated according to the context of each region though the result of W.I will not completely reflect the actual situation of some of regions in the DR Congo. All participants requested to see the result of the WI as soon as possible in order to call for another meeting to start planning on how to resolve their problems.

C. Gbadolite, D.R. Congo
   Date: August 13, 2002
   Participants: 48 from 4 different denominations
   Secretary: Rev. Wangane Gombo
   Facilitator Local: Rev. Luyada Gbuda
   International Facilitator: Rev. Mossai Sanguma
   Sponsored by: The Evangelical Covenant Church of Congo or Evangelical Community in the Ubangi-Mongala regions of Gbadolite Church.

   The World Inquiry was conducted twice in Gbadolite. The first meeting gathered 48 people who were not going to participate in the Mission Conference called COMICA 2002. Church leaders asked if they could participate in the study of the World Inquiry document. They felt that by doing

so they would learn from it.

In plenary session, topics that were brought to discussion and suggestions were:

1. Division within the Church because of ethnic or tribal gain
2. The lack of training leaders are at source of several problems in the Church
3. Many people do not have vision for world mission and evangelization
4. The destruction of infrastructure by the civil war made impossible public transportation
5. Analphabetism was one of the issue
6. The lack of cross-cultural awareness in world evangelization makes difficult the Church growth.

The discussion went on until the session was closed at 7:00pm by a word of Prayer by Rev. Luyada Gbuda.

D. COMICA 2002 at Gbadolite
City: Gbadolite, D.R. Congo
Date: August 23, 2002
Participants: 170 from the Congo, the Central African Republic, and Equatorial Guinea. These participants represented 35 denominations and Christian ministries.
Moderator: Rev. Danu Ngele
Local Facilitator: Rev. Fohle Lygunda
International Facilitator: Rev. Mossai Sanguma
Sponsored by: The Evangelical Covenant Church/USA and the Evangelical Community in the Ubangi-Mongala regions.

It was very interesting that COMICA 2002 took seriously World Inquiry as one of the tool to assist in planning strategically for world mission and evangelization. The time was given from 8:30 am to 1:30pm. Though the assembly has been given enough time for this research, they were not satisfied. Amazingly enough is the result and immediate commitment of all participants in world mission.

Copy of declaration by the assembly on the fact will be added in this report.

Several observations were made in terms of the translation from English to French that did not allow people to understand right away what the document meant. The International Facilitator, Rev. Mossai Sanguma, together with several Church leaders who participated in World Inquiry, Abidjan had to explain more to the

assembly. They also were concern of the World Inquiry, to them was too broad and they could not think straight to things to their own context.

As a result of the discussion, the subjects that took more time in the study were:

1. Division within the Church and Mission: Issue of partnership
2. Analphabetism
3. Racial and Ethnic Tensions
4. Lack of Training capable leaders for the ministry

The result of the discussion enabled the whole assembly to take serious decision in evangelizing the un-reached people starting with those who are in the heart of Africa.

An Immediate Result: The Missionary Center in the Heart of Africa

One of the resolutions of COMICA 1 had to do with the creation of a sub-regional school for missionary and vocational training. This resolution came from discussions during the closing session. The immediate result of the search was the gift of a parcel of land that can accommodate three training programs: a School of Cross-Cultural Missions in the African Context, a center for pastoral training of two years for those pastors who have not attended a Bible institute, and a program of continuing education (decentralized course in leadership) for leaders of churches and Christian ministries. This 1/3 of an acre empty lot in the city center of Gbadolite has already been acquired.

The CEUM, which took the initiative of organizing COMICA 1, will have a primary role in creating this center through the services of SEFAM (the Service for Facilitating Mission). A project to construct three buildings: a dormitory with 40 beds, an administrative building, and a library connected to the lecture hall has already been organized.

The Missionary Center in the Heart of Africa will be a place for mobilizing and providing the resources necessary for seizing the challenge of evangelizing the un-reached and barely-reached peoples in the heart of an Africa torn apart by conflicts and crises. The three training projects mentioned above, and initiated by the CEUM, will make up the essential activities of this Missionary Center in the Heart of Africa. These will be available to all churches. Entrance applications to these different training programs will be available in August 2003.

FINAL DECLARATION OF THE MISSIONARY CONFERENCE IN THE HEART OF AFRICA - "COMICA 2002"

By: Service de Facilitation pour la Mission - CEUM
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We, the 170 participants representing 35 denominations and Christian ministries at the Missionary Conference in the Heart of Africa, COMICA, held at Gbadolite, in the Democratic Republic of Congo, from August 17 to 23, 2002, after five days of work in plenary sessions and workshops, in view of the greatness of the Lord¹s harvest where the challenge of unreached peoples is pressing, have drawn up the following recommendations to present to the churches and Christian ministries:

Mobilization

- The conference suggests that the mobilization of our churches is of the greatest urgency. Because of that the mobilizer must have the following characteristics: be a born again Christian; have a passion for souls; have a divine call; develop daily an enthusiasm for work. Given this task he must mobilize the resources: human, material and financial.
- Mobilization begins in the family, in local churches, in denominations and in Christian ministries. It will be supported by the media (radio, television, newspapers), in conventions and conferences, in Christian publications, and in prayer groups. It will use commitment cards, publicity, educational institutions, and meetings between church leaders, communal meals and series of sermons.
- Mobilization is carried out through planning and at every other opportunity in obedience to the Great Commission.

Training

- Teaching on the mission of the Church must have the place of primary importance in the different activities of our local churches.
- A common program must be developed for our educational institutions, with an accent on the practical aspects of mission: the development of techniques for learning languages; the establishment of a sub regional interdenominational school for missionary training.

Support

- Put the accent on getting leaders

and other members of the churches on board
- Promote the education of Christian entrepreneurs and the establishment of micro-enterprises
- Employ the resources and technical abilities already available
- Encourage alliances between the different development organizations
- Strive to interest Christian business men (and women) in this work

Administration

- Put in place a dynamic and flexible administration that is fully aware of the urgency of the mission, and that has a command of the fundamental principles of management; that is, that can foresee needs, can organize, order, control and coordinate the movement
- The creation of a missionary committee with the task of promoting and seeing the missionary work through to the end

Partnership

- It is essential that the churches avoid isolationism, the erecting of doctrinal barriers and prejudices. The conference urges them to have mutual respect and confidence based on biblical principles
- Partnership can be developed in the following areas: the collection and distribution of information, the development of human relations, of information and in strategic planning
- There should be regular meetings of the experts from each community [denomination] and ministry, as well as instruction in partnership
- Finally, the conference recommends that this present conference be called COMICA 1, and that future meetings be rotated among the participating countries.

WORLD INQUIRY: NAIROBI

By Steven Kabachia
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By the end of the Nineteenth Century Kenya became a British protectorate. For easy administration, the British started a railway construction that was to join Mombassa at the Coast and Kisumu on the shores of Lake Victoria. This project progressed very well and by 1899 it reached the site of what is now called Nairobi. The word "Nairobi" is derived from a Massai word "Enkare" meaning a place of cold water. Also the Railway Engineers chose Nairobi as a camping site because it was almost at equal distance from Mombassa and Kisumu. Also it had ample of flat land and good water from Nairobi River.

Due to all these factors, the railway headquarters was moved from Mombassa to Nairobi the same year the railhead reached Nairobi. After the railway headquarters was moved in July of 1899, the line was opened to the traveling public in August of the same year. With this development, the government administration of Ukamba province, in which Nairobi lay, was in the town of Machakos (a place of Jasaku) forty miles southeast of Nairobi. Therefore, their capital of the Ukamba province was transferred to Nairobi in August of 1899. Things moved so fast that by the end of 1899, the government had selected a site on the high ground on the north side of the Nairobi River and away from the railway station. All this time the colonial Capital was in Mombassa. However it was moved to Nairobi in 1907.

Nairobi City had about 4,300 people by 1900. Europeans, Asians and Kenyans were all present at the foundation of this City. Each of these groups brought with them their religion. However, more mission work increased with the completion of the railway. But the focus was not urban but rural. According to Shorter (1991, 62), just as the early church ignored the rural areas, so the Nineteenth Century Church ignored the towns. So the missionaries who evangelized Nineteenth and Twentieth Century Africa inherited the anti-urban bias of the contemporaries and co-religionists in Europe.

With the coming of independence in 1963, there arose an influx of people from the rural areas to the city of Nairobi. Both local and international Evangelists started to hold big Gospel campaigns to reach the City, which continues up to today. A research done by Daystar in 1989 showed that 80% of Nairobians are Christians. That same survey also disclosed that 60% of the Nairobi people are nominal Christians where only 12% of Nairobians

attend church on a given Sunday.

The reality is the church has not fully discipled the City. This is evidenced by the High Crime rate, Tribal groups like mungiki controlling some parts of the City, increase of street children, prostitution and AIDS scourge, infighting in the City hail and etc. The big question is, “Has the church lost the City?”

The answer is A BIG NO. The church in the City has woken up to its God-given responsibility of being an Agent of Change. Pastors all over the City are coming together in prayer meetings regardless of their denominational affiliation. There are overnight’s prayer meetings and early Morning Prayer meetings in churches and government offices.

The church is also getting involved in other causes that affect their members and especially in the area of good governance. The church is vocal in moral issues like AIDS, Divorce, and Abortion and so on. The City church also increasingly becoming involved in missions both locally and beyond our borders.

However, the church in Nairobi City has been given a lot by God. And since to whom much is given, much is required, the church should do more. A revival of unity and Revivalization is a must if the church will win the City.

STREAMS OF BLESSING CONVERGE IN CAPE TOWN

By: Johan Combrinck
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New Transformation Flow in South Africa

The Cape Town Inquiry (October 8-10, 2002) brought together approximately 110 leaders from 6 African countries - Botswana, Namibia, Swaziland, South Africa, Zambia and Nigeria. About 50% of the delegates were from the Western Cape region of South Africa (SA). This event – the fourth annual National Consultation on Saturation Church Planting - was hosted by the Church Planting Alliance of South Africa (CPA). It was hosted in partnership with the Advisory Committee for Transforming and Serving Cape Town (ACTS), representing the "Transformation Movement" in Cape Town. The theme of the consultation was, "Transforming our Cities through Saturation Church Planting."

While not large in number, the group significantly represented the different denominational and missions structures in the country, especially those committed to seeing more cooperation and focus on strategic integration of the evangelism task in and from South Africa. As such, the consultation also served as a forum for several significant transformation streams to converge into a broader flow of potential blessing for the nation.

Point of Convergence for Four Streams

The past few years have seen the emergence of several dynamic evangelism and ministry streams in South Africa. Among these, four complementary strategies seem now to be better positioned, as a result of this – and other recent events – to be at a dynamic point of convergence. They all agree that South Africa needs a more coordinated and strategically integrated National Evangelism Initiative, focused on the discipling of nations.

Among those included are: "Jericho Walls / NUPSA," serving the broader Body in South Africa, and around the continent as a strategic national and continental prayer mobilization network. Dr. Bennie Mostert leads "Jericho Walls" International Prayer Network.

Also part of this group is the Church Planting Alliance of SA (CPA), with its clear message that strategic, systematic saturation church planting is needed to put feet to the transformation vision. Their goal is "A Healthy Church in Every Small Community". The core partners of the CPA include; AFnet, AMR, and TEASA (The Evangelical Alliance of SA), respectively led by Dr. Johan Combrinck, Rev. Dean Carlson, and Rev. Moss Ntlha. The other

two streams of convergence include the" Transformation Movement" and a dynamically emerging "Leadership Stream."

The Transformation Movement has picked up tremendous momentum over the past year, since the first "National Day of Prayer" event on March 21, 2001 at the Cape Town Newlands Stadium. Forty Five Thousand people gathered at the Stadium that day to repent and to seek God's Face for the City of Cape Town. Since then 8 stadium events have been sponsored in other cities, bringing together over 300,000 people across the nation for prayer and reconciliation. The "Transformation Movement" led by a Christian businessman, Mr. Graham Power, has a vision to take this initiative from Cape Town to all of South Africa, and then on to southern Africa and the rest of the African Continent.

A further dynamic ingredient to this process is the flowing together of yet another track that we broadly refer to here as the "Leadership Stream." Opinion polls taken among African Christian leaders – also during the Cape Town consultation - clearly indicate that the shortage of effectively trained Christian leaders in Africa ranks among the top concerns for the Church in Africa. Dr. Johan Combrinck of AFnet stated that, "The Church in Africa will succeed or fail by its ability to raise up, train, and release godly leaders."

A spontaneous re-positioning of several international structures committed to addressing this issue further evidences the significance of this flow. Many groups such as African Enterprise and WorldTeach are already committed to more effective partnerships around this cause, and TOPIC – SA (Trainers of Pastors International Coalition – South Africa) recently called a full-time facilitator to coordinate these efforts in South, and southern Africa. Recently the Lord also sent to South Africa Dr. Bruce Wilkerson, founder of "Walk Through the Bible." He has already relocated to South Africa, with a minimum 5-year commitment to live and work in South Africa, primarily addressing the issues of leadership training and AIDS.

The Overarching Theme: God's Glory!

With a focus on City Transformation, a clear message was presented that while united prayer, persevering leadership, reconciliation, and research are essential factors that prepare a city for the rapid advance of the Kingdom, Saturation Church Planting is a critical aspect of the battle plan to make it happen, i.e.: "putting feet to transformation."

The CPA emphasized that transformation becomes possible to the degree that life-giving churches are firmly planted in communities. Without the visible and active Incarnate Presence of Christ in the community, and within physical and cultural reach of every individual in that

community, there cannot be true transformation.

Graham Power, agreeing with Dr. Bruce Wilkerson's recent challenge to transformation leaders, stressed the fact that unless leaders are transformed in accordance with the admonition of 2 Cor. 7:14, then transformation of society also will not become a reality.

Bennie Mostert admonished the group that leaders mobilizing prayer and prayer movements, without personally entering into more intimate relationships with God through personal prayer and intercession, likewise, will not see revival come to this land.

While every presenter came with a different emphasis, all were able to link their presentations on the central theme of the consultation. Nevertheless, there seemed to be one overarching theme. Clearly the spirit of the moment pointed to the awesome glory of God. The message that came through that strategy is good. Plans are needed! But most presenters pointed attention away from their personal or organizational objectives. Ultimately the reason for transformation, the goal of SCP, the purpose of united, concerted intercession and strategic prayer mobilization was the "Glory of God Revealed!"

Reverend John Thomas, of ACTS, carefully summarized this sentiment, when in his closing remarks on the consultation he said: "The dynamic strength of the CPA and this consultation came through beautifully through the fact that nobody on the platform seemed to attract attention to themselves or their organizations… Every presenter seemed to be pointing attention to God's glory, rather than to recognition of self." That is the stuff that transformation and revivals are made of!

On-Going Commitment

Among the commitments that were made and reinforced during the consultation, was a resolve for the whole Church in South Africa to take the whole Gospel to the whole nation and beyond. There also emerged a clear understanding that the Church in South Africa equally shared the responsibility for the discipling of all nations of the world.

The leaders from the greater Cape Town area felt that materialism was the major external factor hindering the spread of the Gospel in their city. With that they felt that the lack of effective leadership in the church was the major internal obstacle to transformation of their city. On the question of what they felt God calling His people to do, they agreed that personal evangelism, and church planting among all people groups was highest on His agenda for them.

The total picture looked a little different when considered from the perspective of

the whole group, which also included representatives from other regions of the country, together with delegates from the five other countries. In that case, AIDS came to the fore as the major external factor hindering the spread of the Gospel, and lack of united prayer as the major internal obstacle. For the group as a whole the primary response of the Church was to let its prophetic voice be heard more clearly.

Again Rev. John Thomas echoed the sentiment of the larger group when he summarized the findings of the Cape Town World Inquiry with the words: "AIDS has given the Church in South Africa its greatest chance for impacting the nation and the world!"

Some immediate next steps agreed upon included: annual days of united prayer; discipleship and teaching in and through the local churches; establishing of 24/7 prayer watches, with a goal to see a million people mobilized into 24 hour – 7 days a week prayer watches by next June; and the mobilization of a saturation church planting movement in, and from South Africa.

The group felt that the following mission statement seemed best to describe its sentiment coming out of the Cape Town World Inquiry: "Mobilizing the whole Church to take the whole Gospel to every city in South Africa so that the country is discipled and there is transformation by the power, the presence and the peace of God for all."

21ST CENTURY REALITIES AND THE DREAMS OF GOD'S SERVANTS

ASIA

For New Delhi and Manila, see Compendium V

LET CHINA KNOW THE WORLD AND THE WORLD KNOW CHINA "A MESSAGE FROM THE CHURCH IN TWENTY-FIRST CENTURY CHINA"

By: Luis Bush
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Introduction

A group of top-level Christian leaders of networks of churches in China, reportedly representing a minimum of one-half of the Christians in China, met together for two days in a unique interchange to understand the realities the Church faces in China and their vision and dreams for the future as well as seeking to know and understand the realities of the Church outside of China. The event was unique in the representative nature of the gathering including both the rural and urban communities, top-level leadership of the major networks of house churches, plus the full participation of several Three-Self Patriotic Movement ("Three-Self Church") church leaders with whom multi-year relationships of trust had been established with the ministers coordinating networks of the house churches.

The Chinese organizers called the event "Let China Know the World and the World Know China." The main leaders from six of the largest networks and from twelve other networks arrived from ten provinces via trains, planes, buses and other vehicles.

An integral part of the consultation was "Our World Inquiry." They shared their story, their burden, and their vision, and what they were now doing in pursuing their vision. Many had been imprisoned for their faith several of them up to seven times. They reported that since a meeting held by President Jiang in December 2001 on religion, the arrests of believers for gathering together have increased.

In the course of the meetings the participants expressed their desire to send a message to Christians outside of China. This press release, read and carefully reviewed and endorsed for publication, represents a core part of that message as it came through in the papers, formal and informal discussion and the Inquiry process. It is outlined in three sections.

Our realities as the church in China at the beginning of the twenty-first century

I. Our vision and dreams for the Church in China

II. Our commitments emerging from the consultation "Let China know the world and the world to know China"

Two major papers were presented by Chinese leaders that set the stage for the event. The first presentation using the latest technology highlighted the realities facing the Chinese Church at the dawn of the twenty-first century while the second gave a detailed view of Chinese church history.

Section I
Our Realities as the Church in China at the Beginning of the Twenty-First Century

The realities were outlined using the two Chinese figures that represent the word "crisis." The first term is "danger" and the second, "opportunity." The church in China is viewed today as at a turning point. Before her are great opportunities yet before her are serious perils as well.

1. China's entrance into the World Trade Organization (WTO) signals a new day for China to emerge as full commercial partner in the world yet presents the danger of the enticements of materialism.
2. With the irreversible opening up of China, as the nation prepares for the Olympics in 2008, the legalization of the house churches is expected over the next few years.
3. There has been division, even betrayals, between the officially recognized Three-Self Church and the unrecognized house churches. Hurt remains within both groups.
4. The perception that the Church outside of Mainland China has done little to heal the wounds but in fact, has promulgated the schism.
5. While in many parts of China the division continues to be deeply felt a fresh spirit of reconciliation between the Three-Self Church and the house church leaders.
6. The Three-Self Church has become liberal in its doctrine and practices, though there are many sincere Christian believers and pastors within it.
7. False doctrine has come in to some of the house churches.
8. The denominationalism found in the protestant Church outside of China is not part of the recent experience, ethos or conviction of Church leaders inside of China.
9. Church leaders are being pressured by denominational group leaders to form denominations in China which they are resisting.

10. The official numbers of believing Christians in China are about fifteen million. The unofficial total is about five times that or approximately seventy-five million people.

Section II
Our Vision and Dreams for the Church in China.

1. As Christians, we wish to be a blessing to the country of China of which we are citizens.
2. We envision an evangelized China and move from the coastlands in the east to the relatively less evangelized central and western parts of our country.
3. We dream of the unity of the whole Church in China.
4. We are being called by God to engage in cross-cultural vision not only within our own nation but beyond.
5. We are calling forth a mission force numbering 100,000 to take the Gospel back along the "Old Silk Road" from where it first came to us in 635 A.D. We call this the "Back-to-Jerusalem Movement" as our intention is to take the Gospel back to Jerusalem itself where the Commission to be witnesses was first given by the Lord Jesus to his disciples (Acts 1:8). This was 1930's home-grown movement which began with the idea of carrying the Gospel on foot all the way back to Jerusalem retracing the steps of the Old Silk Road.
6. We desire for the Church outside of China to join us in the Back-to-Jerusalem vision and invite them to help come and prepare us for the cross-cultural mission.
7. We desire to bless our country of China by engaging in constructive, compassionate holistic mission to help build our society in the twenty-first century.

Section III
Our Joint Commitment Made at "Let China Know the World and the World to Know China"

1. We are committed to bring glory to God in all we do and by faith, joyfully receive and willingly embrace the gift given to by our master when he prayed to our heavenly father saying: "I have given them the glory that you gave me, that they may be one as we are one" (John 17:22).
2. We dream of the unity of the whole Church in China and

appeal to denominational church leaders and representatives inside and outside of China to join us our commitment for unity and the intercessory prayer of Jesus: "I in them and you in me. May they be brought to complete unity to let the world know that you sent me and have loved them even as you have loved me" (John 17:23).

3. Start cross-cultural mission training in our networks and churches.
4. As an ongoing expression of the spirit of this event letting China know the world and the world know China we commit to facilitate and organize similar consultations using the vehicle of "Our World Inquiry" in as many of the 345 cities of China with more than 100,000 inhabitants as can be held within the next two years.
5. We commit to finding and preparing a delegation of one-hundred from China to participate in the next global mission event of Christian leaders know as the Lausanne Forum 2004 as part of our desire to let China know the world and the world know China.
6. We commit to the raising up younger leaders and mentoring them in the ways and mission of our Lord by identifying a young man and a young woman in each city who is between twenty-five and forty-five years old at the time of the global mission event in September-October 2004, seeking to build a community of love and truth among them and send fifty to represent the emerging leaders of China.
7. We commit to serve our country of China as upright citizens desiring God's blessing on our land.

Conclusion

We, participants in this consultation, sensed in the Spirit that this is not only a turning point in the life of China as a nation but that this is also a turning point in the life of the Church in China. We sense that God is bringing forth a new stream of the Church in China which is neither the Three-Self Church or the House Church but "the Church" in China.

FOLLOW-UP GATHERING
INTERNATIONAL CHINA CHURCH RENEWAL FELLOWSHIP (ICCRF)

The ICCRF consultation was held November 18th to 20th, 2002 with a small but representative group attending. The discussion centered on the challenge the Church in China is facing in this 21st Century and how outsiders can best help the church in China. As a result of the discussion, participants realized the importance of continual dialogue and studying to present true and realizable alternatives to emerging church leaders in China as well as give encouragement to growing the church freely, according to the leading of the Holy Spirit. While the majority of the discussion is sensitive, and will not be circulated outside of those attending the consultation, a few broad areas deserve to be shared to a broader audience.

The most serious challenge confronting the house church in China is the gradual loss of their understanding of the Lordship of Christ. Because they were adamant on the issue of Lordship, the house churches were able to maintain their existence under the severe persecution. Now, as materialism invades and is conquering China, the message of bearing one's cross is being diluted in the house church's ecclesiology.

One key paper stated that while the Three-Self Church is in a position to influence religious policy, it will not be the major player for the future of the Church in China. The numbers of Christians in house churches make it essential to keep abreast of the direction of house church leaders and support their efforts. The question was raised regarding the extent to which outsiders should be involved for impacting the directionality of the Church in China. Due to the sensitivity of the issues discussed, the paper presented will not circulate outside of those attending the consultation.

The consultation was very fruitful, as participants shaped the future form of the consultation and the scope of ICCRF involvement. At the end of the consultation all participants agreed to have another consultation in 2003. The actual date was not finalized, but mid-October was suggested. The venue will remain the same as this year.

WORLD INQUIRY IN SEOUL AND BUSAN, KOREA
DECEMBER 5, 2002

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The World Inquiry was conducted in Seoul and Busan, the two major cities of Korea, with the groups of 23 from Seoul and 27 from Busan, though a larger number attended the sessions at the respective places. The first group of some fifty participants gathered at Hallelujah Christian Church, Bundang, Korea, under the auspices of the Korean World Missions Association. Dr. Seumgsam Kang, General Secretary of KWMA and Dr. Sang-Bok David Kim, chairman of the World Inquiry International Coalition and senior pastor of Hallelujah Church led the inquiries following a challenging message from Dr. Luis Bush, who explained the purpose and goals of the World Inquiry. Of some 50 pastors and missions leaders, who came together in Seoul, only 23 less than a half, submitted the inquiry answer sheets to the organizers. In Busan 27 of the second group provided the answers to the inquiry.

The answers to the questions are studied and analyzed. Some observations are made from the answers. To the most of the Korean WI participants certain social issues significant, which had been great concerns in other continents of Africa, South America and even some parts of Asia, such as illiteracy, persecution, AIDS, food and water, and national enablement, have not appealed as significant problems externally or internally to world evangelization in the Korean context.

1. The Major External Challenges Facing the Church Regarding Evangelization in Our City or Country

However, 94% of the 50 respondents perceived (1) pluralism as the most serious external challenge facing the Church regarding evangelization in country (72% very important, 22% somewhat important 22%, not important 6%), perhaps due to the growth of Buddhism, followed by (2) globalism 93% which I do not understand why this is so considered (65% very important and 28% somewhat important), (3) urbanization and unreached social groupings such as the youth 80% (58% very important, 22% somewhat important), which is always an issue, (4) women/gender issues important 75% (21% very important, 55% somewhat important). The interest in feminism among women has been rapidly rising during the last decades, as an important social issue in Korea, as girls are given equal opportunities. One notices 55% regarded it somewhat important in contrast to 21% very important, which means the gender

issue began to take attention. Girls are demonstrating that they are more than equal to boys in Korea. Woman ordination as ministers, elders or even ordained deaconesses, is increasingly accepted in the Korean church. It appears that their influence will also continue to grow in the church. Women in Korean church have always a leading factor for the growth and the strength of Korean church. The 82.3% of the participants reviewed (5) relevance of the Christian faith important (very important 36.3%, somewhat important 46%). I have listed in the order of importance here only the top five of the external challenges, setting aside the rest which regarded as less significant.

2. The Major Obstacles to World Evangelization Internal to the Church

Of all the obstacles listed in the questions the following four received 100% each and the next four between 99% and 88%: (1) lack of effective leadership is chosen to be the biggest problem by all 100% of the participants (76% a big problem, 24% maybe a problem), (2) lack of vision also by 100% of them (a big problem 68% , maybe a problem 32%), (3) lack training of workers by 100% (66% + 34%). These three obstacles are regarded as the major ones by 100% of the respondents in both cities. (4) Lack of effective cooperation and coordinated action between mission agencies is seen as another major problem by 99% (68% + 31%), (5) no common goals or strategies for world evangelization by 94% (64%+30%), (6) lack of appreciation by outsiders of contextualized local distinctives by 86% (54%+32%), (7) unhealthy churches that are not able to reproduce themselves problematic by 92% (50%+42%), and (8) lack of good research and information on the remaining task by 88% of those who answered the questions (50% +38%). These are the top eight obstacles, still others remaining besides the above, but we have not included them here.

3. Ministry God is Calling His People to Do in World Evangelization Over the Next 25 Years?

The 98% of the Korean participants chose (1) Make the Scriptures and Gospel message available in every language by various means as the most important ministry (very much 80%, some 18%), (2) 92% for setting goals for ministry (80% and 12%), (3) 92% for seeking social transformation (62% and 30%, not really 6%), (4) 90% for an indigenous church planting movement within every people group on earth (62%, 28%), (5) 91% for regional and global mission-field partnerships for mission agency cooperation and coordination (62%, 29%), (6) 92% for unreached social group such as youth (66%, 26%), (7) 89% for prophetic voice to the city 89%(40%, 49%), and (8) 84% ethnic reconciliation (36%, 48%). The issues are listed in the order of the greater percentages.

4. A Suitable Phrase (watchword) to Capture the Essence of World Evangelization to Serve as a Unifying Paradigm for the Next 25 Years?

The 98% of the Korean participants chose (1) Disciplining Nations as the most suitable phrase (very suitable 73%, somewhat suitable 24%), (2) 94% for "Fill the World with the Glory of God/God's Glory for All" as the second choice (60%+34%), (3) 94% for The Power, the Presence and the Peace of God for all (47%+47%). The second and the third phrases were a tie which was favored by Africa and Indian leaders. (4) 86% for the Church for Every People was chosen by 86% (54%+32%), (4) The Whole Church Taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole World by 92% (50%+42%), (5) Social Transformation/Transform the World for 84% (24%+60%) followed in the order one after another.

5. How Important Global Structures to Provide to Local Believers to Enhance World Evangelization Efforts?

The 100% of the Korean WI participants supported the following first six issues as important: (1) Leadership development was regarded most important by 100% of the Korean WI respondents (very important 91% + somewhat important 9%), (2) inspiration 100% (82%+18%), (3) pertinent information for world evangelization 100% (84%+16%), (4) functional networks linking by ministry-type 100%(74%+26%), (5) resource networks linking to resources geographical and /or functional world evangelization initiatives 100% (75%+25%), (6) relationship building with other leaders/Fellowship networking opportunities 100% (64%+36%). (7) The report of what is happening in other cities/countries was also considered as much important with 98% (43%+55%), (8) and place for publications on missiological issues both received 96%(39%+57%). The first number within the parenthesis is very important and the second somewhat important.

The Korean World Inquiry participants gave their answers to the questions, but unfortunately have not written out the Meta-Narrative Form which are supposed to describe what the respondents considered the realities of the city or country at the beginning of the 21st century. The number of the respondents was so small that no major conclusions may be drawn, but a small sampling of what the participants answered at the moment regarding the questions listed.

THE CONSULTATION OF TURKIC SPEAKING PASTORS

By: Luis Bush and Sang-Bok David Kim

The Kurultai (consultation) of Turkic Speaking Pastors of Central Asia took place in a beautiful mountain setting that provided an appropriate backdrop for the new stream of spiritual life bursting forth. It was organized by an elected steering committee, which included Kazakh, Uzbek, Kyrgyz, Uigur, and Karakalpak pastors.

The Kurultai of Turkic Speaking Pastors is a gathering of pastors from all over the Turkic language speaking world. This includes the people groups of Kazak, Uzbek, Kyrgyz, Uigur, Karakalpak, Tajik, Turkmen, Azeri, and Turks themselves. We are also inviting some Iranian, Arabic, and Jewish pastors. Kurultai means convocation or assembly. According to the Turkic traditions such convocation has the right to decide very important matters for all nations; it is like Synod of ancient time.

Which group or groups in Kazakhstan or internationally are sponsoring this event? Actually there is not any specific or ongoing sponsor of this conference. All the participating churches are helping in some way: money, providing volunteers, worship teams, prayers, payment for round trip tickets of pastors and leaders and so on. This means no one can say that they are a full sponsor of the conference but all can say that they are playing a part in making the conference happen.

From the dawn of time these same mountains of Central Asia sprung forth streams which often became waves of Turkish people sweeping across the Old Silk road where almost nine of every ten Turkic speaker lives between the 35th and 45th parallels at the outset of the twenty first century.

Riding strong shaggy ponies with sword in hand, they spilled out of their pastures and overran cities and civilizations from Rome to China. From Attila the Hun to Tamerlane the Turk, the barbarian hordes were. Today a new band, who loves Jesus, and carrying the Word of God as their sword, seek to bless the peoples along that same great highway that shaped history.

That was the expectation of the Turkish national leader who organized the event. He explained on the phone the expectations of the organizing committee for this historic Kurultai. Despite the fact that about nine of ten of the 180 pastors who shared the Turkish language had placed their faith in Jesus Christ within the last ten years.

How to pray? Jesus has moved in such a way that His church in Central Asia is truly expanding, exponentially in many areas. But leaders are young, most believers have less than five years in the faith, and few can go deep in the Book. Their vision and priorities are focused on their immediate context.

What to pray for? In the World Inquiry conducted during the Kurultai, one of the questions related to the external challenge facing the church. For those from Uzbekistan the greatest challenge was injustice. This corroborated with the Inquiry taken with more than one hundred lay leaders from that same country six months earlier. Several of the leaders shared their experiences of beatings and imprisonment until almost mid-night one night at the Kurultai. For the sixty who came from Kyrgyzstan and the Kazaks the primary challenge they indicated they faced was religious fundamentalism.

Central Asian Churches Envision a Stream of Blessing along the Old Silk Road back to Jerusalem.

The "S church" is committed to mentoring emerging leaders, multiplication and mission. Since 1996 they have embraced a vision to establish ten churches along the Old Silk road as far as Jerusalem. Already a family from the indigenous people of the area has been sent to one of the most sensitive countries along the way.

On the wall of one of the largest churches in Central Asia there is a map of the Old Silk Road. Pastor "Sam" captured the vision at the Silk Road Festival 2000. The church where three hundred believers' baptisms were conducted the Sunday following the Kurultai has begun a partnership with a mission of 120 professionals ministering to the Turkish peoples all along the way. His goal is one thousand churches by 2010 along the Turkish highway, also known as the "35/45 Turkish Window."

When Luis visited with "Mr. R" several years ago at his home in Almaty where he spoke of what he saw with "eyes of faith," the vision that unfolded from his heart left a profound impression on the six of us who sat on the carpet around his table. "I see a picture of Central Asia," he said. "I see many churches opening. I see two roads across the Silk Route, one going westward toward Turkmenistan to Turkey and another eastward to China. I believe there will be many miracles in Turkey, Afghanistan and China, especially among the Uyghurs, Uzbeks, and Kazakhs. I believe we will see many Muslims come to Christ. In this place we need to prepare many workers to go on these roads. Can you help us?" Today Mr. R. sees a golden thread of blessing that connects the heart of Central Asia to the heart of Jerusalem. The leadership team of this network of Central Asian congregations includes a Kurd, Kazaks, a Uygur, and Uzbeks. They are beginning a training center for

preparing those to go forth to bless the region to the east and to the west along the Old Silk Road. [If you are interested write to Mr. R at nur.kaum@nursat.kz] To God be the glory!

Reconciliation Ministries: Outreach to National Leaders

In the Central Asian countries, pressure on Christians is on the rise, in any forms, including newly proposed highly restrictive religion laws. Christian churches are still widely perceived as cults, alien to the society. In the midst of all this fear and ignorance, a Christian lawyer has been encouraging Christians in the region to be slat and light in their communities and to boldly proclaim basic biblical principles of good citizenship. "We need to tell the government what we believe and then live the talk," he says. Working for several years in the region to assist in the legal reconstruction process following years of communism there is a growing network of young Christian lawyers in reconciliation ministry. Exciting new bridges are being built to connect the rapidly growing church to the political leaders who are responsible for development of these new nations. A declaration detailing basic scriptural principles for good citizenship and ministering in a sensitive manner has been approved by a large group of pastors and will soon be presented to the president of the Kyrgyz Republic. Similar initiatives are contemplated in other parts of the region. For more information or to find out how you can assist in this exciting ministry, email mbristol@pmbx.net.

Restoration Ministries: Outreach to Substance Abusers and Families

From one survey done in Kazakhstan one in every family in Almaty is either an alcoholic or a drug addict. With "D" and his team the largest in Central Asia. It has 166 full time workers scattered among the eight residential programs. It has started a non-government school for street children, orphans and addicted ones as young as eleven years old. To accommodate the other young boys in the community, a football club has started. The work is also extended to the prison where some of the orphan boys are from. Two-thirds of the full time workers are from the majority-people background whose families have been transformed after seeing the extraordinary changed in the lives of their children. Nine congregations have been established and are now pastored by former graduates of the program. Ten full-time Uighurs are in various stages of training and in action in China.

WORLD INQUIRY REPORT
AHMADABAD, GUJARAT

By Johnny Desai
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An Inquiry on Evangelizing the World was held under the umbrella of EFI in Ahmedabad on 15th January 2003 at the Bible House. This inquiry was conducted by Luis Bush. It was convened by Johnny Desai of EFI. Some 70 people, a few pastors, lay leaders, leaders of mission agencies, attended this consultation.

After a short time of praise and worship, Luis and Johnny lead us into a fuller understanding of the consultation. The group was divided into 10 subgroups which was given adequate time for reflection on the subject. The findings were then reported and after an analysis of the same, the top three challenges in each category were announced, which are as under;

1) On the question of the major external challenges faced by the church regarding evangelizing the city or country, the top three issues were:
   a) Religious fundamentalism
   b) Pluralism
   c) Persecution, political opposition and injustice
2) On the question of the major obstacles internal to the church to participate effectively in world evangelization, the top three issues were
   a) Lack of vision
   b) Lack of effective leadership
   c) Unhealthy churches that are not able to reproduce itself
3) The next question dealt with the question of our belief of what God is calling his people to do in world evangelization over the next 25 years for which the majority of the people felt as under.
   a) Preach the Gospel to every person using personal evangelism.
   b) Make scriptures and the Gospel message available in every language for both literate and illiterate by radio, TV, the Jesus Film, Bible translation, etc.
   c) Seek social transformation
4) Three of the most suitable watchwords to capture the essence of World evangelization to serve as a unifying paradigm for the next 25 years were given as under:

a) The whole church taking the whole Gospel to the whole world
b) The power, the presence and the peace of God for all
c) Christ's Kingdom come

5) Lastly on the question of structures required for the above work, it was decided that the following three were important.
   a) Inspiration and prayer networks
   b) Leadership development
   c) Resource networking locally and worldwide.

The groups met again in the afternoon session to formulate the mission statement. All the 10 groups came out with outstanding mission statements. They all had the following in common. 1) Training of the church for evangelizing; 2) Using strategic prayer for this purpose; 3) Ultimately the power, peace and presence of God may prevail in the city of Ahmedabad.

It was certain that the people who had given their precious time of this consultation were those who were burdened to see the Gospel go with all its power in the city of Ahmedabad. Some people shared of the work being done in the city for the past few years. Notable of them was Pastor B. I. Samuel who shared of the TV programs being broadcast everyday on the Gurjarati channel and the training of local pastors for the work of church planting. John Kant also shared about the slums they had adopted and the social work being used some of the ladies to go and spread the Gospel.

After this encouraging report, a discussion on a common watchword for the city of Ahmedabad was initiated. After some deliberations, it was decided to keep "TRANSFORM AHMEDABAD" as the watchword.

A lookout for leaders for this project was then conducted and 3 people were unanimously given the task of furthering the work. They are Mr. Sunil Kolhar, Mr. John Kant, Rev Julius Christian and Mrs. Shiela Amin. They were blessed by all those present and the meeting was dismissed. All went with an expectation pf some great things to happen in the future. The leaders met for a time of prayer after the meeting and decided to again meet for future planning on 19/02 at the CNI church, Maninagar. Johnny Desai johnny_koki@rediffmail.com.

THE EVANGELIZING OUR WORLD INQUIRY
CHANDIGARH

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Chandigarh, designed by the French architect Le Corbusier, is the first "planned" city of India and the capital of the states of Punjab and Haryana. The city is named after the goddess Chandi Devi, whose white-domed temple stands on the slope of a hill on the north east of Chandigarh. The city is spread over an area of 114 sq. km. and divided into 47 sectors (excluding the number 13). The city's population of nearly a million people is drawn from every community and region in India, and ranks second in literacy in the country. In contrast its sex ratio is an abysmal 773 females per thousand males.

The city is a refreshing change from the typical Indian city – clean, good infrastructure, reliable power and water supplies. The city has neatly laid out roads and parks, boulevards and streets lined by rows of trees and shrubs with the Shivalik Hills as backdrop.

The city abounds in medical and educational institutions acting a regional hub for these services. The city is fully wired with every point in the city within 1 Km of the broadband Fiber optic Cable network. The city government is working hard to build and promote Chandigarh as the preferred destination for IT enabled services.

The words of Independent India's first Prime Minister Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, delivered in 1952, encapsulate his vision for the city: "Let this be a new town, symbolic of the freedom of India, unfettered by the traditions of the past - an expression of the nation's faith in the future."

The first churches in Chandigarh were the Church of North India and the Roman Catholic. Later the Church of God and a Baptist church were built. Since mid-90s there has been a spurt in the number of churches established and Para-church agencies working in Chandigarh. Chandigarh's has a small but active militant Hindu presence whose influence is somewhat limited because of the city's cosmopolitan nature. A campus outreach ministry has reported doors closing on opportunities to organize on-campus Bible study and prayer groups. Mass-evangelism events are extremely difficult to organize.

The churches here have displayed an uncommon degree of cooperation and unity. With more than 100 Christian workers and nearly 50 churches there is a clear and definite witness to Christ in the city. In contrast to most Indian cities,

Chandigarh does not have Christian health and higher education institutions.

Several initiatives have been taken in the last several years to develop a coordinated effort to reach Chandigarh. After an enthusiastic beginning, most of these have been quietly buried. The church leaders of the city desire to work together. The right combination of time, opportunity and anointed leader for a movement to emerge is still awaited.

The World Inquiry on January 8, 2003, at Chandigarh saw 22 church leaders participate. The qualitative survey identified Materialism, Pluralism and Religious Fundamentalism as the most important external challenges facing the church in Chandigarh. Lack of united prayer, churches that can't reproduce, lack of cooperation, vision, effective leadership and research were some of the internal challenges identified.

To 'What is God calling the church to do?' the two highest responses were: set common goals and personal evangelism. Social transformation and reaching all social groups were also seen as important.

"The Power, the Presence and the Peace of God for All" was the preferred watchword. The church's expectations from global evangelical structures were relationship building & fellowship, inspiration & prayer networks and functional networks.

The leaders present agreed to develop a movement that would aim at the total transformation of Chandigarh. The stated goal: "The whole church to reach the whole city of Chandigarh with the whole Gospel in the leading and power of the Holy Spirit by 2010." The hearts of the people should be drawn towards Jesus. Kingdom values are to be communicated to the city through a revival in the church.

An action plan will be developed focusing on prayer, cooperative action, empowerment through information & its communication, and Bible teaching & the sharing of our stories. The transformational movement will aim at impacting the city in the areas of lifestyle, reconciliation, social justice, and economic sufficiency.

WORLD INQUIRY
CHENNAI CITY REPORT

By Joshua Pillai
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The World Inquiry conducted on 11th January 2003 was a great blessing to the City of Chennai in terms of finding out the status quo and challenges ahead of this great city of 8 million people with around 15% Christian presence.

The questionnaire design was excellent and has unearthed crucial issues which draw corporate attention of the Church in Chennai. Although the representation was from a wide cross section, what has come out of the analysis is absolutely the truth. We would like to repeat this process with all the senior Pastors of the city during the following week and also get their inputs and reflections on the present analysis.

The current analysis will forge the leadership to work together towards a transformed Chennai.

In almost all the conferences in the past, we were rushing through the program, but in this global inquiry, we really gave ample time to the participants to share as to what God was speaking to them about this city. This was really helpful and was well appreciated by all who attended. Most of them were high profile leaders who care for God's Kingdom. After my paper presentation, the leaders shared the following comments:

God has placed great leaders and visionaries in this city, Chennai has a city reach initiative for the last six years and is growing from infancy towards maturity, once she becomes a beautiful bride and works together with the Holy Spirit, a transformed Chennai will be born. We are confident that we are not far away from it.

Major decisions taken:

Revised Mission Statement: The Whole Church taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole City so that "The Power, the Presence and the Peace of God are felt by everyone in the city."

Motto of Chennai Net: Working together towards a transformed Chennai.

Other decisions:

1. Invite the heads of the churches in the city to know from them as to what God is speaking to them about Chennai City.
2. Form a Task Force (12 Track leaders) for city Transformation
3. Equip the Task Force and the associates (around 120) to lead towards city transformation.

4. Activate all the 12 zones of Chennai Net.

Prophesies:

1. Rivers of Living Water will flow from this city and bring healing to this Nation.
2. Like Sarah, this city will give birth in her old age and cause city transformation.

World Inquiry Focus Group Analysis on Chennai City

I. What are the major External Challenges facing the Church regarding evangelism in our city or country?
Relevance of Christian faith..... 44%
Religious Fundamentalism..... 22%
Materialism 16%
Pluralism 6%
Others 12%

II What are the major obstacles Internal to the Church to participate effectively in world evangelization (beyond the city)?
Lack of effective leadership 27%
Lack of United Prayer..... 18%
Lack of vision..... 15%

III What do you believe God is calling His people to do in world evangelization over the next 25 years?
Personal evangelism.....26%
Social Transformation.....22%
Church as prophetic voice.....16%

IV What would be a suitable phrase(watchword) to capture the essence of world evangelization to serve as a unifying paradigm for next 25 years?
Whole Church 32%
Church for every people 22%
Power, Presence, Peace 10%
Social Transformation.....10%

V How important are the following for Global Evangelical Structures provide to local believers to enhance world evangelization efforts?
Inspiration and Prayer networks.43%
Leadership Development.....23%
Pertinent Information 10%

External Challenges for the Transformation of Chennai

- Crime Rate in Chennai:
  1. Dowry harassment cases in Tamil Nadu (50.6%) are reported in Chennai
  2. Consumer fraud (in shops, car garages, petrol bunks etc.) is more in Chennai (39.4%).
  3. 175 murders reported in the last 3 years.

- Drug Addiction: It is estimated that one kilogram of Heroin is sold each

day to about 20,000 addicts in Chennai. Drugs smuggled to Sri Lanka via Tamil Nadu cause a spillover in Chennai and this is sold on the streets. Heroin is priced anything between Rs.50-100 per packet fro 50mg-1gm. Source: The Narcotics Control Bureau.

- Child Beggars: Conservative estimates say there are at least 75,000 child beggars in the city. Police officials say that many of these children were kidnapped and then maimed to evoke sympathy they beg. Source: NGO

- Chennai Roads: Chennai's roads are a nightmare for motorists and pedestrians alike. Roads are constantly dug & Manholes uncovered for cleaning purposes are not replaced.

- India's Health Capital: The expertise, professionalism, and commitment of medical staff set Chennai apart. Source: Premium health care.
    - Apollo Hospital: The hospital has completed largest number of coronary bypass surgeries, in one place-15,000. The success rate is highly impressive 98.5%. They completed over 2,000 angioplasties and 1,000 kidney transplants.
    - Sankara Netralaya: It is considered as best ophthalmic hospital in India. The top quality eye-care combined with cost factor attracts 1300 patients a day

- Suicides: Chennai has the highest number of Churches in India, yet we have highest number of suicides. The suicide rate in Chennai is 17.2% per 100,000. The suicide rate among males ages 20-40 years old is 55.45%, and among females the same age it is 65%. It is found that 60% of suicide victims lacked any kind of religious faith.

- Premarital Sex: Studies show that pornography has become an integral part of many students' lives. According to the study there is 2.3% increase in "sexual intercourse with non-regular partners" among male students in past four years. Homosexuality is slowly gaining acceptance in the city. Source: AIDS Prevention and control project (APAC).

- Organized Crime: There are 59 criminal gangs. These gangs will undertake any criminal activity for gain. Source: 'Organized crime study of criminal gangs in Chennai' by former Deputy Commissioner
    - Mercenaries: They murder for money and undertake

criminal jobs like assaulting, disfiguring, maiming, and kidnapping.

- Theft: The gangs are well organized and have separate departments for purposes of surveillance, planning and execution.
- Prostitution: Prostitution is well organized and finely networked into brothels
- Bootleggers: They involve the distillation, transportation and marketing of illicit liquor.
- Drug traffickers: The drug gangs operate in three layers. The top layer includes the leader, assistant or the second in command and patrons of the gang. The lower level sells the drugs.

- Abortions: Official figures say there were 12,321 medically terminated pregnancies in Chennai last year. There is a growing number of abortions in the 14-19 age group. Source: Professors of Gynecology and obstetrics at the Kilpauk medical college hospital.

- Eunuchs in Chennai: There are nearly 400 eunuchs living in family-like colonies throughout the city. Mentally and emotionally think of themselves as female. They all are commercial sex workers without exception. Begging on trains, making weekly trips to shops and offices for money.

- Runaway girls on the rise: Every year, more runaway girls turn up in Chennai's railway stations, churches & streets. The girls range in age 4 – 24 yrs. They are open targets for sexual abuse. If a girl doesn't find her way to a safe place within 15 minutes, she is ruined.

- HIV/AIDS: Spread of HIV/AIDS in India is reaching alarming proportions. A large number of young people are infected each day. An immoral lifestyle is one of the main causes for spread of this virus. Source: World health organization (WHO)

- White Collar Crime: includes cheating, defrauding and counterfeiting currencies and documents are on the rise in Chennai. A good number of white collar crimes have been busted by the police at Flower Bazaar and Villivakkam areas. The police also recently busted a parallel telephone exchange network that was operating in the city and caused lakhs of rupees loss to VSNL.

- Elder abuse: old people have become a burden to their children. The aged are finding themselves at the mercy of younger family members who resent having them around.

- Chennai Slum: Chennai has the largest slum population in Tamil Nadu. The total slum population in Chennai is 1,079,414. The slums reflect the despondency and disillusionment of its inhabitants. Source: 2001 Census.

- Pollution:
  - Vehicular emissions: are the city's major polluters. Only 70,830 of the total 1,127,392 vehicles plying the road posses valid Emission under Control (ECU) certificates.
  - Noise Pollution: The noise levels in the city sometimes reach maddening heights.
  - Waste Disposal: Even though there are rubbish bins provided for waste disposal, people often throw rubbish at the bin rather than in the bin resulting in rubbish all around the bin instead of inside it.

- Crime against women in Chennai: Chennai city with the highest crime rate against women among 23 mega cities. However, for countless girls and boys in the city even home is not a safe place to be in. The other major area of concern is dowry harassment and deaths. Source: National Crime Records Bureau.

- Water Scarcity: In summer 2,000 of the total 13,500 streets in the city do not get water. With a rise in the population from 3.87 million to 4.5 million, Chennai consumes more water than ever before.

- Child sex in Chennai: By recent study in 15 localities of North Chennai revealed that nearly 27% of children in age group 10-18 had engaged in sex. Nearly 24% of those surveyed are involved in rag picking and 8% have taken to "pimping" for Commercial Sex Workers in and around Central & Egmore railway stations. Almost 6,000 children live with mothers who work as prostitutes. Source: Karunalaya Society for Social Service.

- Child Labor: Child labor in city garages. The daily routine for the boys begin at 7.30am and extend well beyond 10 in night. Some are as young as 3 yrs old, they get Rs.2 per day. Experienced kids 10-14yrs old earn Rs.50 a week.

- Bonded labor: More than 1000 families are working as bonded laborers in rice mills in an around the Red Hills. There are 1,630 children in the rice mill industry, 40% of them are below 5yrs of age and 50% between 15-18 yrs. Only 200 odd children were in schools to receive non-formal education, while 70% remain untouched.

- Sindhis: There are more than 25,000 Sindhi families in Chennai, they

moved into the city soon after partition. The Sindhi Hindu Mandal Association in Egmore is an agency that helps Sindhis. They run Sindhi Model School & College.

- Jains: There are around 5 lac Jains in the city. The community is concentrated in Sowcarpet, pockets of Red hills, Ayanavaram & Mogappair. Jains from Gujarat & Rajasthan are mainly swetambars and might have come here 200 yrs ago. Jains rank 3rd in promoting education, medicine & social service. Some of the major businesses in Chennai are run by Jains.

- Tibetans: There are 120 Tibetan students studying in Madras University and 75 children at Children's Garden Matriculation high school. Tibetan women can be seen in Parry's, Purasawalkkam & other parts of city selling woolen sweaters, mufflers & socks etc.

- Toilet Shortage: Chennai is one of the dirtiest cities in India. For a population of 4.2 million, the Corporation has built 850 public conveniences. Several of these are shut down for lack of maintenance. There is just one toilet for every 3,000 students in Corporation schools. Public Toilets are used for peddling drugs, illicit liquor and prostitution.

- Prostitution: An estimated 3,000 women in Chennai are involved in selling sex. Only 400 of these women work in brothels. Nearly 700 ply their trade on the streets and highways. A whooping 800 prostitutes are married and work from home! 20% of commercial sex workers are teenagers. Women are sold to brothels or pimps for anywhere between Rs.1000 - Rs.50,000. The average of a Chennai prostitute is 30. About 45% take up prostitution in order to feed and educate their children. The remaining 55% use sex as an easy way to make some extra money.

- Chennai's youth search for a spiritual fulfillment: Young people are looking for peace of mind through spirituality. Started in 1983 with just 10 members, ISKCON now has 200 members. Source: Youth Club of International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON)

- Reaching children: children under the age of 15 make up nearly 40% of our population. They are better informed and given the liberty to take independent decisions. Source: The Hindu Folio October 1999.

- Lepers in Chennai: Chennai city alone has 16 leprosy colonies. Lepers can be found begging. Source: March 1991 statistics.

- Cross-Cultural Migrants: Chennai has at least 4 lakh Kannadiga settlers. We also have a sizable population of Telugu, Keralite, Punjabi, Parsi, Oriya, Bengali, Marwadi migrants.

- Divorce Rates: In the year 2001, two thousand divorce cases were filed. Majority of the couples were in their twenties. The reason for divorce in most cases is infidelity. An increasing number of Christian marriages are also ending in divorce.

- Stress in the city: A study found that urban people suffer from 'psychological overload.' City life has taken its toll on Chennaites. Commuting to and from work, long working hours and inadequate leisure time have stressed out most of Chennai. Even children are not spared the stress of an urban lifestyle.

- Civic Conditions: Chennai's civic conditions are crying for attention. The Municipal Corporation is controlled by the members of both major parties so there is no unity in decision making, leading to personal ego clashes. Citizens suffer as result. The municipal corporation had earmarked Rs.70 crores last year for the maintenance and relaying of roads but much of it remains unutilized.

- Smuggling: Chennai is emerging as an important place for smuggling of goods by air. The value of seized goods from the international airport was Rs.20 crore in 2000 & 01 with intelligence sleuths detecting smuggling in gold, foreign currency, narcotics and electronic goods

THE REALITIES OF LUDHIANA CITY

By Alex Abraham
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The city of Ludhiana is in Punjab, North West India the abode of 24 million people of which 60% are the Sikhs and 34% Hindus. Christians form only a small 1.1%. Ludhiana is the industrial capital of the state. Christian missionaries from the Presbyterian churches from the United States came to Ludhiana in the mid 1800s and established the missionary work in Ludhiana. In 1894, a Christian Medical School for Women was established by Dr. Dame Edith Brown which is still one of the powerful witnesses of God's faithfulness in this region. In the late 1800s, there was a mass movement lead by a Dalit called Ditt. The Lord raised a powerful man of God from Ludhiana called Sadhu Sunder Singh in the early 1900s from the Sikh background. John Hyde a famous man of God was powerfully used by the Lord in the early part of last century.

The current status of Ludhiana City: In a systematic survey conducted by Operation Agape, the following observations were made. The city has about 2.4 million people, which includes a number of people who have migrated to the city for job opportunities especially from the poor states of India like Bihar, UP, etc. Ludhiana city is the industrial capital of Punjab. The whole city is divided in to 70 wards and 410 colonies each with an average population of 5000. Each ward has about 5-8 colonies and has about 25,000 people.

What does the Church look like in the City of Ludhiana?

There are 72 Main churches and 308 house/cell churches in this city. Of the 70 wards, 40 are still without any churches and 264 out of the 410 colonies have no gathering of believers. The Ludhiana city has about 65 full-time pastors and many other lay leaders/tent makers. The research team has prepared the map with all the churches in the city systematically marked which is also being updated constantly. It was interesting to note that a good number of churches are located near the Christian institutions in the city where are many other areas are not in the church map of the city. Many of the missions and churches are being challenged to do pioneer work in the unreached areas and unreached people groups.

The Ludhiana City Harvest consultation was held on the 7th of January 2003 at the Christian Fellowship Church, where about 80 pastors and leaders of the city came to seek the face of the Lord and see what to do based on the harvest survey reported which was presented to them. They also saw the Transformation Video on Kali Columbia which was a great challenge for

them. Dr. Luis Bush challenged the city leaders to continue to pray for the wonder working hand of God to move in the city.

The following observations were made during the World Inquiry survey held on the 7th January 2003.

I. Major External Challenges facing the churches in Ludhiana. Religious fundamentalism and materialism , globalization , unreached people groups are the major challenges, in the order of preference .

II. Major Internal Obstacles reported were: 1. Lack of effective leadership; 2. Lack of vision and lack of united prayer

III. Global Evangelical Structures should come forward to help us in. Leadership development, Inspiration and prayer networks and Relationship building/ fellowship

IV. Dreams of the leaders . The following are some of the dreams of the leaders of the city: They want to start a united prayer initiative to see a total transformation of the city in this decade and also see that Bibles are available in every language groups in the city. The city leaders are committed to see a church in every urban colony by 2004 and see 1000 churches by the year 2005 .

The following two Watchwords were suggested by the city Leaders:

1. The Power, the Presence and the Peace of God for all
2. Whole Church taking Whole Gospel to the Whole World

Prayer was felt as the main strategy to bring in this reformation. Many of the churches are already having 24/7 chain prayer groups set up. Several of the churches have now All Night Prayer Vigil once a month. 24 Hr prayer sign up sheets with items for prayer has been distributed the churches and many have taken prayer seriously. On the 21st of March, about 40 people from different churches gathered together for an All Night Prayer Vigil. The city map was placed on the floor, which was prayed for. The spiritual mapping is under progress and information was available from nearly 40% of the wards. Every one of the strongholds was prayed for as a preparation for the harvest.

The whole movement is called Ludhiana Transformation Movement. We request you to join us in praying for the city and for its total transformation.

21ST CENTURY REALITIES AND THE DREAMS OF GOD'S SERVANTS

AUSTRALIA

THE CHALLENGE OF TAKING THE GOSPEL TO THE CITY OF SYDNEY

In Sydney, Church leaders, representatives from departments of evangelism and leaders of Christian organizations were invited to meet to hear a report on Lausanne and its plans for the proposed Forum in 2004 and to reflect on questions being asked across the world through the World Inquiry. There was good attendance and the members took seriously the World Inquiry and discussed the questions and gave their comments. In Sydney the whole Christian church is greatly influenced by the strength of the Anglican diocese of Sydney which is clearly evangelical and provides a very strong theological teaching program at its seminary. All the other denominations are also evangelical with only one denomination having a mixed tradition. The Catholic Church is also strong and its new Archbishop is conservative and concerned to see biblical principles pursued. Many of those who attended this meeting had been participants in either or both of the Lausanne Conferences in 1974 and 1989.

Sydney is the oldest and largest city in Australia with a population of 5 million.

According to the Church Life Survey, 70% of the population believes there is a God, but only 10% attend church weekly. Of these, 33% are over the age of 60 (whereas only 19% of the community at large is in this age bracket) and 34% are in the 15-40 age bracket (54% of the community). 67% of Anglican attendees have been going to church for at least 5 years while 3% were attending for the first time on the occasion of the survey.

Twenty percent of Sydney's population was born in non-English speaking countries. The Chinese and Korean Christians have an active outreach program among their own ethnic communities. Most ethnic communities have at least one church often linked to the Baptist or the Anglican Church with a few linked to the Uniting Church. The Roman Catholic Church also has congregations for most ethnic communities.

The Sydney Anglican diocese is committed to evangelism and has recently set a goal to see 10% of the population attending Anglican Church (this is clearly not to move people from other denominations but to reach out to non-church goers). Most denominational schools have a clear policy to seek to have a strong Christian influence in the life of the school and Chaplains are appointed with the skill for relating to students in a relevant way. There are many 'Christian' (often parent controlled) schools and these are also having an impact for the Gospel. Christian organizations and Chaplains at the four Sydney Universities also pursue an active outreach and teaching program.

There is a growing emphasis on using the opportunity the church has of sending into the Government schools, Scripture teachers for one period a week.

Outreach to those who have migrated to Australia with a non-Christian background is being given a major emphasis in a number of denominations.

The hope for Sydney, particularly as voiced by Anglicans is to see 10% of the population committed to Jesus as Lord and Savior.

Comments on the Challenge of Taking the Gospel to the City of Sydney

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21ST CENTURY REALITIES AND THE DREAMS OF GOD'S SERVANTS

EUROPE

BUILDING A MOVEMENT FOR CHANGE IN THE UNITED KINGDOM

By John Smith

Commitment

Evangelical Alliance, representing a constituency of over1million Christians across forty denominations throughout the United Kingdom, has cast a vision for building a Movement for Change which aims to release Christians as agents for change in society in order to achieve societal transformation. The vision, first launched in autumn 2000, was developed in an Assembly of Evangelical Christian leaders meeting in Wales in 2001 which explored issues of Society, Truth, Discipleship and Church, and has been expressed through 2002 in a collaborative mission initiative *face values.*

Realities

Successive surveys of church life across the UK show decreasing church attendance statistics and particular difficulties in reaching children, young people and Gen Xers. Post-modern Britain has become by and large post-Christian Britain. In a multicultural, though increasingly secular society, political correctness reigns supreme, with churches and other faith groups often feeling marginalized and regarded as irrelevant by society. Tolerance is the cardinal virtue except when faith groups make exclusive claims in respect of truth. Society is then increasingly intolerant of exclusivity.

Nevertheless, there are signs of hope and there are Christian ministries which buck the trends and churches which are growing.

The ALPHA Course emanating from Anglican Holy Trinity Brompton continues to help many thousands explore basic Christianity and crosses streams of churchmanship. The radical ministry of the Message in inner city Manchester provides one example in which it is claimed that crime rates have dropped as a result of Christian witness. Evangelist J John packs cathedrals and other large venues across the nation with his contemporary teaching series based on the Ten Commandments. Many evangelicals are reaching out through social action in ways unprecedented for over a century. Politicians are open to being convinced of the demonstrable benefits of Christian care through salt and light ministries.

Dreams

Evangelical Alliance sees a Movement for Change as a big vision which requires commitment to the long haul and recognition that it may take a generation for change to be apparent in society.

As the 2002 expression of building a Movement for Change *face values* provided an opportunity for churches to participate in holistic mission across three tracks - society, evangelism and community, using the resources of over eighty partner mission agencies, presented in a Church Pack. An interactive CD ROM – adaptability - provided a diagnostic tool for churches to investigate their current level of involvement with their community.

A poster series, used sequentially on church notice boards across the country throughout the summer, raised issues of love, respect, and trust culminating in an advertising campaign around the theme of forgiveness for two weeks in September. Prayer Points were established in offices and shopping areas as Christians invited prayer requests from the general public. Resources equipped churches for a Say Sorry Sunday, exploring aspects of forgiveness. A National Forgiveness Day caught the attention of commercial radio stations. Kim Phuc, the girl in the famous Vietnam War picture, now a UNESCO peace ambassador and a committed Christian lady, was featured in the British media speaking on the theme of forgiveness. There were values-based fringe meetings in party political conferences and placement of articles in national press and spokespersons on radio spots as the church held up forgiveness as a value for life. This values engagement with society will continue in various forms as part of the Alliance's commitment to be a prophetic voice to society.

Meanwhile a new expression of Movement for Change – *change makers* - will help church leaders in the strategic task of releasing church members as 'agents for change' – turning the church inside out to turn the world upside down. The Alliance will seek to be a provocative voice to church, exposing Christians to new models of church which may be effective in a post-modern society.

A theological colloquium explored the history of movements and the way they could be stimulated or harnessed to achieve kingdom objectives.

A further phase in the development of a Movement for Change will involve research into the practical, demonstrable benefits of Christian action in society. This will be presented as an apologetic for the church, particularly in the area of government funding for community projects where sometimes the faith content of Christian projects disqualifies them from grant provision.

Evangelical Alliance continues to hold strategic conversations with member organisations and others who share the vision of societal transformation through a Movement for Change.

WORLD INQUIRY REPORT
WORTHING, WEST SUSSEX, UNITED KINGDOM

By Stephen Kelley
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Introduction

A small but significant group of Christian leaders from the south of England gathered to discuss issues related to the Church's responsibility for World Evangelization in the future. Representatives from the leadership of several churches, mission leaders serving globally and representatives who are first generation Christian converts from non-Christian faiths all joined in pursuit of understanding what God is saying to the church concerning missionary responsibility. Both regionally and globally, it was agreed, God is calling us to "look to the fields that are white unto harvest." This consultative process allowed each of us the opportunity to re-dedicate ourselves to faithfulness as "ambassadors for Christ" in a world in need of reconciliation to God.

Inquiry Observations

In review, the following was acknowledged;

1. At the local level, there is a call for revival and an outpouring of God's Spirit. The smaller number of participants was in part due to a larger gathering of church leadership within the near communities that had just occurred and which continue as a monthly event. This was an indication of a sincere desire to hear from God in our day and to respond in spiritual power to spiritual needs.
2. At the national level, it was acknowledged that the day we live in sees a rising thrust of unbelief and ungodliness that calls for a response from God's people in service and transforming commitment.
3. At the global and multi-cultural level it was acknowledged the peoples of the earth are well represented in the United Kingdom but that too often we have built walls rather than bridges for the Good News of the Gospel.
4. At the international level it was acknowledged that there are many "hidden faces" of God's people who are voiceless and powerless, living under ethnic and religious oppression. We, who have a platform for speaking to the larger Body of Christ, bear responsibility to bring them in a communal way into the fold as part of the Great Shepherd's flock.

Inquiry Consultation: Status of World Evangelization

1. Major External Challenges.
   Materialism and pluralism are the primary external challenges to Great Commission responsibility. The Church has been weakened by a loss of biblical understanding of the uniqueness of the Christian faith. Further, our effectiveness has been diluted too often by a quest for material rather than spiritual answers for "wellness." Among unbelievers there is a void of relevance seen in biblical faith coupled with a lack of confidence that the Church has much to contribute to their hopelessness.
2. Major Internal Challenges
   Prayer is the major need for this challenge for God's people. As we seek His face, we will set right our global priorities with a vision for world evangelization. As we set right our own hearts in obedience to Him, new vision will arise in our own hearts.
3. God's Call for Response
   Our own revitalization will demonstrate a new priority for the Scriptures, made available in every language and for every people group. The Church will again be a prophetic voice to the masses, presenting the Word of God as central in the community of faith and relevant for all who seek life.
4. Watchword
   The watchword has been left to us by the Lord Himself when He mandated us to "disciple the nations." The whole church taking the whole Gospel to the whole world is still relevant today as a watchword for us.
5. Structures
   Structures to facilitate all of this are secondary to the people affected. But inspiration and prayer networks are essential and will cultivate a rising group of godly leaders to carry us forward. Information and prayer networks are essential to global mobilization, and call for structure as a means rather than an end.

Inquiry Emerging Narrative

The outcome of our time together led us to realize the continuing "nomadic nature" of the people of God. We find ourselves constantly dealing with lost and scattered sheep in a dangerous environment. The doctrine of the sovereignty of God takes on fresh meaning as we realize the ungodly forces that influence human history are engaged against us but <u>will not prevail</u>. We find the church much more at home in the wilderness looking for the Good Shepherd to lead us forward. Meanwhile, our nomadic role is to prepare the way of the Lord by presenting Him as the way, the truth and the life, by which all

who search may find their place with the Father.

Inquiry Outcomes and Conclusions

1. We commit ourselves to "seek His face" as a necessary prerequisite to addressing a lost world.
2. We commit ourselves to "present ourselves as living sacrifices" available to bring the Gospel to the nations.
3. We commit ourselves to "empower as we can" the silent voices and hidden faces of the Body of Christ who have been both oppressed from the unbelieving world and repressed within the Flock of God. Among us were those who represented first generation believers from "closed countries" who now have an opportunity to speak on behalf of the scattered flock. We acknowledged that if one part of the Body is in pain, the whole Body suffers and must respond together.

As pilgrims in process … nomads on a journey …voices in the wilderness, we call upon our Brothers and Sisters in the Faith to join us in announcing the Good News – there is a Good Shepherd who has given His live for the Sheep. Follow Him with us to the ends of the earth!

CAMBRIDGE, UNITED KINGDOM
A SEEDBED OF WORLD IMPACT IDEAS
PART 1: AN INQUIRY INTO HER PAST AND PRESENT CONTRIBUTION TO ADVANCE CHRIST'S CAUSE

By: Luis Bush

Walking the quaint streets of Cambridge, nestled in corners and on pedestals amidst ornate gothic buildings, you are confronted with statues of well-known personalities of the past who left their imprint on the city and the world through their ideas. For more than five hundred years Cambridge has been a seed-bed of ideas.

Cambridge started as a school of divinity inheriting a modified monastic style of living. The Colleges were built like monasteries. In the chapels the pews face each other. Seven times a week, students read the 150 Psalms to each other as had the monks before them.

To thousands of students coming through the famous halls of Cambridge University, appeals were made to sew seeds with their ideas for the good of humanity.

Lady Margaret (1443-1509) sewed the seed of Christian charity and education. At Christ's College Gate and then again at St. John's College Chapel stands Lady Margaret Beaufort's statue. In 1502 she founded the Lady Margaret professorships of Divinity at Oxford and Cambridge as well as Erasmus' three-year stay in Queens' College.

Erasmus sewed the seed of Christian scholarship and "Laid the egg that the Reformers hatched." In front of St. Johns, today's visitor sees the statue of Erasmus. Of all the books in Cambridge it can be argued that the book he was working on while at Cambridge did more to change the course of history than the others. He came to Queen's about 1510 and worked on the New Testament.

It was while my older brother John was a student at Cambridge that he read Erasmus' letters to the Pope on a silent retreat at which he came to faith in Christ. Not many years afterwards John shared that same faith with me which I embraced and radically changed the direction of my life.

The work of Erasmus on the Greek New Testament was the seedbed in Cambridge into which Luther's three books of 1517 was birthed which changed the course of England and the world, bringing fruit in lives such as that of Hugh Latimer.

Hugh Latimer was instrumental in making Cambridge a seed bed of spiritual renewal and reformation through his vigorous preaching and through the inspiration of his martyrdom. He wrote the book of

prayer of the Anglican Church. At the stake Latimer immortalized himself by exhorting his fellow victim Ridley with the words "we shall this day light such a candle, by God's grace, in England as I trust shall never be put out."

One person, born almost one hundred years later, would carry the same candle of faith to light up new realms of understanding for mankind.. He was Isaac Newton. Isaac Newton (1642 - 1727) in the year 2001 in the UK was recognized as the man of the millennium for his world impact ideas. A bystander, looking from across the street to the entrance of Trinity College, will find the apple tree which became a key in terms of his understanding of the law of gravity. Inside the chapel at Trinity is a statue of Newton. The son of an English farmer, Newton became the professor of mathematics at Cambridge University in 1669 at the age of twenty six. He was led to Christ in his first year (1662) by his tutor, Isaac Barrow. He followed the principle of studying the two books of God, the book of the Scriptures and the book of Nature. He declared he could make no discovery unless it was communicated to him by the Holy Spirit.

It was at Cambridge that William Wilberforce (1759-1833) prepared to become a British politician and philanthropist who from 1787 was prominent in the struggle to abolish the slave trade and then to abolish slavery itself in British overseas possessions. The Slavery Abolition Act he had sought was passed one month after his death.

Conclusion

In my brief sojourn at Cambridge in 2001, while conducting an inquiry into the New Testament Gospel and its Implication for the twenty-first century under Professor Graham Stanton, Lady Margaret professor of Divinity, I realized first-hand that much can be learned to inform, inspire and challenge the church from a brief look at some of those who sowed ideas for good from this famous university town.

CAMBRIDGE, UNITED KINGDOM
PART TWO: AN INQUIRY INTO HER PRESENT AND FUTURE

Glenn Myers
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Reflections prior to Inquiry by Glenn Myers: Cambridge Christian Streams

1. Academic Christianity. The faculty of theology, true to the national context outlined above, has rebadged itself to emphasize 'religious studies' over Christian theology. Cambridge theologians are making no discernible impact on mainstream British society. Previous generations of Cambridge theologians (the Reformers, the Puritans, Westcott, Hort), of course have. Cambridge professors in other disciplines still do affect society today. For example, Lucasian Professor of Mathematics Stephen Hawking's books sell in their millions, ironically because they offer answers to the very ontological questions that are the rightful province of theology.

2. Student Christianity. Is strong but arguably in need of a generational overhaul. In the 1920s the IVF superseded the SCM over the issue of liberal versus conservative theology. (IVF was more conservative.) The CICCU (IVF) group appears (to this observer) to be stuck in a modern/evangelical mindset and culture and I would anticipate it being supplanted by something equally Biblical but culturally postmodern.

3. Church life. Twenty or thirty years ago, Cambridge's great evangelical churches were Anglican or old-established non-conformist like Eden Chapel or St Andrew's Street Baptist. In the last 15 years there have been a number of new church plants of independent churches, some of which are linked with apostolic networks. In my view they have more vitality than the old evangelical churches and will grow to become at least as significant in the Cambridge scene as the older churches. With that said, the older churches are still full of vigor.

Networking has been a problem in Cambridge, partly because of the strength of individual churches. City-wide missions have not, in my memory, been very successful. Some of the newer churches (like City Church) have proved themselves to be more flexible and gracious when it comes to networking than some of the older ones.

4. Innovations. In the world outside the church, Cambridge is a world-class city of innovation. Silicon chips, designed by ARM, power two-thirds of

> the world's mobile phones. Cambridge's Welcome labs sequenced the human DNA, and won themselves a share in this year's Nobel Prize. Arguably no real estate on earth has trained more political leaders, or spawned more Nobel Prizes, than these few acres of fenland.

Have there been 'spiritual innovations' to match? I don't see too many at the moment, though others will have a vastly better informed perspective than I do. The Jubilee Centre/ Relationships Foundation attempts to reshape social policy in the light of Biblical values. Maybe, students somewhere are starting other things that one day will have a national impact.

On a much smaller scale, a few churches and groups are modeling forms of social service that share a common pattern: the state provides the funding and framework of care; the Christians shape the culture of care. I'm thinking for example of the Romsey Mill (youth and family work) and Zion Baptist Church and St Martin's Anglican churches, who each run respected, council-sponsored facilities that are staffed and managed by the churches. In this way, links are forged with integrity between living churches and the broken and needy… which is surely, at least, one essential step for the churches back to the heart of national life.

Reflections at Inquiry by Focus Group:

The 'Cambridge Inquiry' was a focus group made up of a cross-section of Cambridge Christian leadership that met at St Martin's Church on 14 Nov 2002, part of a global research project whose results will be presented at the Lausanne 2004 conference. It looked at the future of the Christian movement, both locally and globally, partly through questionnaires (which have been forwarded to the Lausanne folks for processing) and partly through open discussion. We had an enjoyable and stimulating time together, fellowshipping, and discussing. Here's a synopsis.

Our discussion focused on the obstacles and priorities for the future and rather took for granted the variety, history and current diversity of the Christian movement in Cambridge. The problem that clearly stood was this one:

Churches focus to an unhealthy extent on themselves and their ministries

Flowing out of this were many consequences, illustrated by comments from the group: 'stuck in a rut,' 'marginalized and not realizing it,' 'not in contact with outsiders,' 'not presenting a coherent message as Cambridge Christians,' 'Too concerned about our individual integrity [as a successful church]

rather than about listening to what the world thinks of us.'

This 'spiritual self-sufficiency' also prevents us from realistically engaging with the large areas of unmet needs in Cambridge: families; children and youth; ethnic minorities; and geographic areas like North Arbury which have very little home-grown Christian witness. And it impedes our witness to Cambridge culture as a whole.

There was less consensus on how to address this issue, beyond the clear call simply to embrace the principle that God has given us good gifts but that we also need each other.

Ways of working together are likely to many and varied and not every group will be happy with every initiative. Being committed to the networking principle seems to be what counts. Someone used the phrase 'being Church [in our local expressions] and overflowing.' Though there are and have been good examples of initiatives that involve more than one group, we are generally a bit short in the 'overflowing' department at the moment!

Networking ought to include both church groups and specialist agencies, like Romsey Mill or the Jubilee Centre, for example. These agencies are often deeply in tune with real needs and could function as eyes and ears for the wider church.

Many thanks to all who kindly took part in what I found to be a fascinating, unique and enjoyable evening. I've included your names in the second half of this note, though I suppose I have to take responsibility myself for these written conclusions, such as they are. If you want to sound off about what I've written, do, and I'll circulate it.

Glenn Myers
Mission journalist, WEC International, and a member of St Martin's Church, Cambridge, November 22 2002

EVANGELIZING OUR WORLD INQUIRY
CITY OF ESSEN, GERMANY

By: Rolf Zwick
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In consultation with the Essen World Inquiry Participants

Introductory paper

The city of Essen, Germany, now in the year 2002 celebrating its 1,150th year of existence, started as a mission station. It is good to keep in mind that Christian missionary work was the beginning and the objective of the foundation of our city.

The reformation in the 1500s was introduced mainly by the citizens, rather than the clergy. In 1559, the people of the Market Church sang Christmas Carols in German and in effect drowned the Latin singing and the words of the local priest from the Essen catholic cathedral chapter.

In 1792, 3,600 people lived in Essen, and one hundred years later its inhabitants grew to around 100,000. The percentage of protestant Christians remained the same over the years - about 40%. However, it was only in 1900 that the city of Essen was structured as an independent protestant district

During the Nazi regime the movement of the Confessing Church resisted the government. Wilhelm Busch, a youth pastor and evangelist in the Weigle-Haus as well as Gustav Heinemann, a lawyer were two of their leaders. Busch and his successor Ulrich Parzany mainly influenced the evangelistic movement in Essen after World War II.

The annual "Teerstegen-Conference" and "World Mission Day", "Church Festival under the Word" in 1984, youth festival "Christival" in 1976, and the Protestant Church Congress in 1950 and 1991 together with many missional events were important milestones. However, the spiritual impact did not always come through.

The "Evangelical Alliance" in Essen ignited many important missional sparks after WWII. It was always dominated by the free churches, but men and women from Protestant churches, from the YMCA and the Protestant "Weigle-Haus", are also engaged. In 1993 the "Evangelical Alliance" organized the first "ProChrist"-rally with Billy Graham. Among adults, the main mission today is ProChrist 2003, a mission week in Essen's Gruga-Hall that will be transmitted via satellite into approximately 1,000 European cities.

From 600,000 inhabitants, approximately 190,000 are Protestant and 290,000 Catholic. 2,500 belong to one of the free churches. 11 % are foreigners, mostly

Muslim, who have built 12 mosques. The number of inhabitants is declining. In the time span between 1962 and 1999 the number has already decreased by 20%. Wealthy families are moving into the nicer surrounding areas.

In a city losing its inhabitants and church attendees, (the Protestant church loses 0.8% of its members every year) it is important to provide hope by mission programs and spiritual sparks.

There are several migrant churches in Essen (e.g., 4 Korean and about 10 African churches) which are growing and appealing also to German Christians. Most migrant churches are associated with the charismatic or Pentecostal movement. Their evangelistic work is infusing new life into some of the traditional structures.

There are visible emerging spiritual movements in the existing churches in Essen right now. In the Catholic and free churches, these new beginnings are mostly associated with the charismatic movement. They take place in small groups of the Catholic churches, while free churches are being influenced by new models of worship and worship services. Some Protestant churches foster the mission initiatives by new forms of worship, discipleship classes, small groups, and youth events.

For ten years, a monthly united prayer for Essen takes place with 30-40 people attending. A common prayer of leaders from different backgrounds was installed two years ago, this year a monthly citywide youth prayer and worship event was started. Among the youth a spiritual awakening and new citywide activities are visible (YOU fare, Pray2Move, Alliance youth prayer event).

There is a desire for fresh spiritual life and missional movement among the Christians of Essen. Please join us from around the world in prayer and write me if you wish at rolfzwick@Compuserve.com.

ESSEN DEMONSTRATES THE ESSENCE OF A WORLD INQUIRY BY EMPHASIZING THE ESSENTIALS

By: Luis Bush

Introduction:

Sitting around the tables as the groups focused together on the issues affecting the evangelization of their city and the world, it appeared to have the makings of a model Inquiry process despite the admission of the organizer that this was "a first trial." More than four hours later as he walked out he said: "Even I am surprised." The reasons for the significance of the event were because of: A. the people; B. the process; C. the preparations; D. the problem handling; F. the paper on the city; and, G. the perpetuation of the process.

A. The People: One of the first questions when the people had gathered was: "What were the criteria for inviting the people to come?" because they saw people they would not normally speak with. That was what created an atmosphere that prompted interaction as the people represented a diversity of church, ministry and vocational backgrounds. One-third were women. About three-quarters were lay people. The total number of thirty who participated was ideal for conducting an inquiry. There were teachers, pastors, engineers, younger leaders, business executives, artists, denominational leaders and a national leader.

B. The Process: The sequence of the phases of activity and the timing flowed with one moving along naturally from another. By the end of the four hours only two had left and everybody else wanted to continue the dialogue. The phases were as follows:
   1) Prayer
   2) Opening remarks by the host
   3) Overview and inspiration by outside resource person (30 mins.)
   4) Quantitative survey for each individual by one of the city leaders (30 mins.)
   5) Break with something to eat (30 mins.)
   6) Qualitative survey by focus groups of five people (40 mins.), presentation of the paper on the city by a respected leader in the city (20 mins)
   7) Review of the document all together with discussion that went beyond the document to the next steps (40 mins.)
   8) Summary and next steps by city leader (10 mins)

9) Summary perspective of the resource person on why there is hope for the city (10 mins)
10) Worship and prayer.

C. The Preparation:
1) The person took responsibility for the event and to call people to tell them about it
2) The materials were translated into the language of the people and photocopied for each person
3) Letters of invitation were written and those who did not respond were called him
4) The research done and the writing of the draft of the story of the city included the context of the city, the realities of the church in the city and 3) the drams and vision for the future.
5) The arrangements in the room were made to allow the participants to sit and face each other with tables for their materials.

D. The Problems:
1) Were faced openly by the organizer
2) The problem of the timing. In a European context, for example, you need four to six months to prepare such an event
3) Often involved clarification of the meaning of the questions

E. The paper on the city sought to reflect he story of God at work in the city in narrative form. It included the challenges of the city at the beginning of the twenty-first century, the church in the city and the nature of the mission of evangelism with the people and programs God was blessing ending the vision and dreams of God's servants in the city for the future.

F. The Perpetuation:
1) Spontaneous expressions of desire by participants to facilitate similar consultations in other cities.
2) The need for and desire to have a follow-up gathering to review the results and look together to the future was decided upon.

Conclusion:

New streams are beginning to flow in Essen. There is a youth prayer and mobilization movement. The international immigrants are making an impact in the city and bringing life to the historic churches. Ten years of united monthly

prayer meetings is beginning to bear some fruits of greater unity of the ministers of the city.

"These signs of more blessing to come emerged in the final moments of the discussion together and participants departed in a spiritual atmosphere of unity, joy and hope" (Rolf Zwick, organizer).

A MERGER FOR MISSION: CASE STUDY OF NORWAY

Tore Askilsen (tore.askildsen@norea.no) and Luis Bush

Introduction:

On occasion of the World Inquiry with Church and mission leaders in Oslo on April 18, 2002, a fresh model of a national integrated church-based and mission-based organizational structure came into view.

Three national bodies of church and mission merged into one. The Lausanne Movement, the Norwegian Missionary Council, and the Norwegian Evangelical Alliance have become NORME (The Norwegian Council for Mission and Evangelization), the sponsor of the Norwegian Inquiry.

During an interview, Egil Grandhagen, nationally respected historic mission leader and mission historian, described in detail the development of this new structure. Grandhagen served as general secretary of the Norwegian Lutheran Mission, the largest mission agency in Norway, for nineteen years. He is now teaching the history of mission and New Testament.

1. What happened to bring NORME into being?

   Phase one: Initial informal dialogue between Grandhagen and Tjorbjorn Lied during the mid-1990's: Increasingly they felt, along with other church and mission leaders, that there were so many meetings and coordinating bodies that some of them should merge in order to be more effective since usually it was the same people gathering together.

   Phase two: Overseas Mission Council (OMC) meeting.
   This led to the meeting of the OMC which was convened by Lied in 1998 where the issue of an appropriate national structure was brought to the wider body. The OMC was the only evangelical structure in Norway that linked all the different churches and mission agencies in the country. At that event it was decided to take an initiative with the evangelical alliance and the Lausanne Movement and the AD2000 network to come together for reflective dialogue concerning a structure that could accommodate each of the groups.

   Phase three: Merger of evangelical Church and mission bodies.
   This led to the merger at a meeting in the year 2000 attended by representatives of these bodies. After discussion, they decided merge into one body the church-based evangelical structure (the Norwegian Evangelical Alliance) and the missions

based evangelical structure (the OMC) and the structure concerned about evangelization (the Lausanne Committee). Rolf Kjode, previous secretary for the Norwegian Lausanne Committee, whose full time work is with youth leaders, was appointed leader of the new body.

This led to the establishment of the Norwegian Council for Mission and Evangelization (NORME) on the 1st of March 2001. There is no longer a separate church-based evangelical structure or evangelical alliance in Norway. Grandhagen noted: "We hope to keep a priority focus on evangelization and missions. By using both words in the organization name as well as in the dominant representation of mission leaders, it ensures the ongoing purpose of the structure to be the church active in evangelization and missions."

2. What realities had to be faced and obstacles overcome?
   a. Limited resources of people, time and money to support involvement in various global events, committees and activities.
   b. "The AD2000 Movement energy was going to be absent and the question arose of how to fill the gap."
   c. There were some tensions in the discussion on the question of whether to include representation from the ecumenical structures.
   d. The concern that there would be a loss of mission vision and initiative because the church-based structure would absorb the different perspective of the mission based structure. As a church historian Grandhagen teaches his students about what happened when the International Missionary Council (IMC) merged with the World Council of Churches (WCC) and consequently lost their mission's vision. He downplayed that concern saying: "But I think the mission agencies represent such a major part of the new body that this will not take place in Norway."

3. What does it mean?
   The merger means that, in the view of leaders in Norway, from the major streams of evangelical Christianity, there is more that links them together than that divides them at the beginning of the twenty-first century.

4. Why is it significant to the global church/mission community?
   a. From a historical point of view as a church historian: "it is clear that evangelical Christians in this country are able to work together."
   b. Because of its disproportionate influence in the world Christian community because it ranks at the

top of mission commitment per congregation as it is the second country in the world with the highest number of missionaries per congregation.

c. Because it is likely that other nations will follow their example. This was the model for instance in the discussion on the topic in Germany in October 2000 between the representatives of the church and mission bodies associated with the European Evangelical Alliance. Already in other countries of Europe a similar merger has happened or is in serious discussion.

Concluding remarks:

What will occur over the next quarter century and beyond as a result of this structural integration of church and mission in Norway remains to be seen. What influence this will have on the merger of mission and church structures in other countries of the world remains to be seen. But, if this is indeed a stream of God-activity in a new day and new world, it could mean that this tiny stream become a major river of God's flow in both a new century and millennium.

A Story of What God Is Doing In Norway from a Younger Leader

Sometimes one wakes up by ones alarm clock surprised that the dream one was dreaming was not reality. You weren't on your way up Mount Everest, or you weren't flying easily over grassy slopes as a bird. Instead you find yourself in a groggy state of trying to wake up. Gooood morning!!

I had such an alarm clock wake me pretty roughly not long ago. I heard about a team of Kenyan youth who came to Norway, not to learn about all the good and right stuff we do in Norway, but to be an inspiration to Norwegians – to be evangelists and motivators. Well that's all nice and good! Mission fields sending people back to the missionary-sending countries sounded quite nice until I heard that the Kenyan selection-process of those who could participate in such an outreach in Norway was very thorough. Only those with sterling integrity and truly Christ-committed hearts could take part in such a team. Well, that was interesting, but my alarm clock didn't really go off before I heard that the reason for such a selection process was <u>not</u> that the Norwegian society was so secularized and various temptations were strong, but the reason was – that the normal lifestyle of Norwegian Christians was so secularized that the Kenyan leaders of this outreach think it poses a real threat to their young missionaries.

Now that's a pretty heavy alarm clock in my ears!

What is going on in Norway?! That is the question I will try to address in the short time I've been allotted.

If I may I will very, very shortly give us a bird's eye perspective of our history and current realities.

A thorough reformation process eradicated the Catholic Church in Norway and paved way for the state church in the 16th century. Ministers were and are still are educated in the Germanic-scientific-theological tradition.

Hans Nielsen Hauge was a front figure in a dramatic change in the spiritual climate in Norway around the years 1800-1820, a climate that enhanced the laypersons responsibility to be an active and devoted Christian. Several waves of revival during the 1800's gave the foundations for several mission-societies being established in the late 19th and early 20th century. Also free churches of various denominations were established during the 19th century, but until the Pentecostal movement came in the dawn of the 20th century, the free churches remained a marginal phenomenon that grew stronger in the revivals between the world wars. In terms of *active and confessing* Christians the situation today is by some estimated to be about 50-50 between the state church and free churches, even if the number of members in the state church is far beyond the free churches.

The mission agencies, who mostly based their identity in Church of Norway (the Lutheran Norwegian state church), have contributed to Norway until quite recently being the country in the world, which sent out most missionaries in comparison with our population. The lay ministry organizations and mission agencies functioned as a cross-structure in the Norwegian church - engaging and inspiring the church members. What we see today are new structures being formed as parts of the older structure is crumbling between our fingers. The classical mission agencies are struggling, both economically and personnel-wise. Even if there are signs of ongoing vitality - the main missionary force from Norway still comes from these organizations - there is a clear sense of urgency in the need for renewal. The Church of Norway has lost and many places are still losing generation after generation of its members who slumber into a passive and nominal membership. On the other hand, it should also be mentioned that the evangelizing potential in being the traditional church for the people of Norway gives Church of Norway extraordinary opportunities. There are in several dioceses a number of evangelical parishes taking advantage of this.

The relationship between the traditional lay ministry/mission organisations and the Norwegian church is rapidly changing. As a wave of vulgarised state-churchism has been working a while, the message from a growing part of the state-church is a blessing of the non-churched, non-biblical based faith - a kind of religious feeling about life, universe and everything. The foundation for this fundamentally flawed

theology is an approach to the practice of baptism and baptismal education, which is marred by pragmatism and void of biblical foundation. In my opinion, this vulgarised state-churchism produces a strong vaccination against what the church is all about: reaching people with the Gospel so that they may become whole-heartedly followers of Christ. That's what an evangelical Lutheran church as the Norwegian state-church should be up to. As a result of the actual situation the lay-ministry and mission organisations are rapidly gaining a new self-understanding. We see more and more that the organisations take care of their own members' spiritual needs, and several places they actually establish their own churches - mostly with the blessing of the State Church.

The free churches of various denominations have gained a lot more self-esteem during the past 20 years than they have ever had before, even though their numerical growth has been very slow. Some of them have contributed with a positive challenge to the state church, inspiring a renewal of congregation building and evangelizing consciousness. For the last decades most churches and organizations seem to have had their child and youth ministry as their clearest evangelizing effort.

Also new cross-denominational networks are emerging as a positive response to the challenges we face. For instance Alpha courses nationwide have led to what must be called a silent and unobtrusive revival. Focusing on small-group type of ministry, the Alpha-courses have hit a nerve in our time. People need fellowship. People need to listen and talk and being seen in a well-defined group setting. Another nerve is the need for absolute basic teaching on what the Christian faith is all about - not as academic theory, but what its all about to be and live as a Christian. In an age when social networks are heavily damaged due to various reasons, there is a crying need for structures which gives individuals opportunity to meet others.

Other new cross-denominational structures are the "Church-growth" movement with Christian A. Schwarz's research as ideological foundation. Presently over 100 congregations in Norway use this material to enhance their evangelizing and community building effectiveness. Another such network is the Norwegian branch of the Willow Creek Association who recently gathered 2000 participants from all kinds of denominations to be inspired in being evangelizing communities. They also conduct widespread teaching in community building and evangelizing effectiveness.

A recent, quite thorough investigation showed that not less than 53 percent of Norwegians believe in God, 22 percent call themselves Christians (which is a rise from 20 percent in 1985), but at the same time

only 4-5 percent attend church or Christian meetings fairly regularly. (That means that 95% never do!)

We face challenges on several levels. Our cultural situation is marked by an exceptional materialistic approach to life on the one hand and on the other hand a post-modern relativism, which negates any attempt to share ones faith with anyone else. This culture permeates also the Christian communities and rids them of much of their evangelistic zeal. As an example I'd like to mention a meeting between Norwegian youth and east-European evangelical youth, which I participated in a couple of years ago. The east-Europeans shared with tears about their tribulations, but that they were being strengthened in what they experienced as persecutions and they functioned as witnesses in their schools. The Norwegian and Scandinavian group reported that they did not experience persecutions, but if they tried to share their faith, they were met with barely a shrug. "That's fine for you. I've got my stuff. You've got yours. Have a nice day!"

From another perspective we also see clearly a new cultural wave coming with the young generations up to about 30 years of age, were any kind of membership in a traditional organization or church is just not relevant. They are zealous, but completely uninterested in church structures and organizational life. In my opinion this cultural wave is a challenge and a real opportunity for the Christian community for renewal and maybe even a new age of revival. For this to happen, we need, really really need, bold and courageous leaders who dare to lead as the Holy Spirit prompts them. We need leaders who let go of traditional leadership styles and venture into the much more unsafe grounds of servant leadership and flexible, dynamic and organic organization styles. I am convinced that the institutions who cling to the organizational and leadership-styles of the last century will perish, sooner than they fear.

The society surrounding us demonizes us when we try to stick to the bible as the authoritative guide for our lives. We see a lot of young leaders rise and shine, but decline astonishing rapidly. The percentage of burnouts among young Christian leaders is worrying. Several reasons can be given for this; among them could be lack of internal personal strength due to the widespread experience of broken relationships. Also a high speed society with competition instead if cooperation in focus seems to be destructive. We live in times of crisis on many levels seen from a God-perspective, but also – and that is what I want my main thrust in this address to be: surely times of great possibilities for the cause of Christ. Various initiatives have arisen to equip young leaders to face the challenge of our age. A wave of young Christians are letting go of established church life and are trying

to find a way for themselves and their generation. But the pain of change is truly felt. We are in an age of great change. May God lead us in that change so that Kenyan and other Christians will love to send all kinds of missionaries to Norway to cooperate with Norwegian God-touched, soul-winning, sin-mourning, salvation-rejoicing Christians? As every single person is invaluable to God, but lost without Christ, our lives and struggles must be in the Lord, led by Him, and freed from the chains of our age into renewed action and boldness to reach the people who live in our age - the 21st century – reach them with a clear and compelling invitation to meet the Living Lord of the Gospel.

WORLD INQUIRY REPORT FROM SOFIA, BULGARIA

By: Nik Nedelchev
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A one-day consultation took place on 13 December 2002 in Sofia, the capital of Bulgaria. As Luis Bush was not able to come, he asked Nik Nedelchev to facilitate the discussion. Pastors, youth leaders, men and women involved in various ministries, most of whom are highly educated and staff of the Theological Seminary in Sofia attended the consultation. There were representatives of all Evangelical churches in Sofia - from mainline conservative to charismatic. Some people were from Para-church organizations affiliate to the Bulgarian Evangelical Alliance (as you know, the Lausanne Committee and the Bulgarian Evangelical Alliance merged in 1993 and since then they have existed as one body).

The meeting started with prayer. Each person attending was committed to work actively and we spent several hours together. It was a great success that participants decided to share the idea of the World Inquiry in other cities in Bulgaria eventually the next two months. One of the missing points was that we were not able to have Gypsy people with us.

I. Describe the realities of the city at the beginning of the 21st century with a brief high level perspective of the history and characteristics of the city (100-150 words)

SOFIA

Sofia has been the capital of Bulgaria for over 100 years. Its motto reads 'Ever growing, never aging' and it's a dynamically developing city. The area of Sofia has been inhabited since ancient times. Archeological finds discover it to be over 3 000 years old.

The town has a rich history. It was part of the Roman Empire and there are several remains of that period. Later the Bulgarian country was established in 681. It was an independent country neighboring Byzantium to South-East, the Adriatic Sea to the West, the Black Sea to the East and Dacia (present-day Romania) to the North. The Northern border followed the Danube.

Christianity was declared official religion in 865. The greatest development of the country was between 9th-12th centuries. The Turks came and occupied the country in 1396. During the Turkish domination the church existed unofficially and was strongly persecuted for several centuries. The church was also strongly

influenced by the Greek Orthodox Church. Bulgarians were not allowed to conduct their services in Bulgarian but in Greek language. In 1870 the Bulgarian Patriarchy regained its autonomy.

Historically, the country played a key role because of its strategic geographical position. Several of the Crusades passed through Bulgaria. The Bulgarian or the Slav language was one of the first languages (after Hebrew, Greek and Latin) that started to be used in the church liturgy and worship.

The two brothers Cyril and Methodius created the Slav alphabet. There was no Reformation in Eastern Orthodox countries and that's why the first Evangelicals came to spread the Gospel of Jesus Christ in 1842. They were sent by the American Mission Board in Boston, Massachusetts The four Gospels were translated and published in Bulgarian language for the first time in 1844. In 1852, Baptist, Congregational and Methodist missionaries came to Bulgaria. The churches were not very strong but had a high reputation. They were working very hard for spreading the Gospel among intellectuals after the liberation from the Turkish domination in 1878. A good evidence was the establishment of the American College. About 47% of all prime-ministers in the period 1878-1944 were graduates of the American College. They had a good American high school and Bible Seminary, which existed in Samokov until the communist party came in power. Churches started being persecuted; many were confiscated or destroyed between 1948 and 1956. Many pastors were arrested and sent to prison.

After the fall of the communist regime there was a revival and since 1989 most of the churches tripled their size. At present Bulgaria is a democratic republic with very bad inheritage from the communism. The economy was destroyed, all retirement funds and factories were closed, and there is a high rate of unemployment. However, this economic and social crisis opened the door for the Gospel of Jesus Christ.

One good evidence was that even before communists came in power there was a very good partnership between people from different denominations. The Bulgarian Evangelical Alliance was founded in 1863 and closed by the communists who put in prison most of the leaders of the Evangelical churches in 1948-1949. At first, the

Evangelical Alliance was formed by Baptists, Methodists and Congregationalists and then when Pentecostals came in the country and formed their denomination in 1928, they joined the EA in 1935 and this is how they functioned until the beginning of the communist regime.

After the fall of the communist regime, the Bulgarian EA was restored again, and another denomination, which had been functioning secretly by the time - Bulgarian Church of God joined the other four. Later the 'Good News' Church emerged and joined the Alliance.

II. What are the realities of the church and mission of God's people in the city at the beginning of the 21st century with a brief high level perspective of the history and characteristics of the Church/mission of God's people in that city? (100-150 words)

Our latest statistics shows that there are 1 530 churches with over 130 000 believers in Bulgaria. Governmental statistics give higher numbers - almost 200 000 believers but it is hard to believe it is so. In Sofia, there are 75 Evangelical churches from different denominations, 3 Catholic churches, 3 Catholic monasteries, 1 mosque and 30 Orthodox monasteries in the area.

III. What are the vital spiritual/ministry initiatives with special focus on the "new things" God is doing in and through His people in the city? Describe any collaborative consortium that is interdependent without losing the autonomy and distinctiveness of any of the cooperating partners. (200-250 words)

A. Existing vital spiritual/ministry initiatives (especially collaborative consortiums)

Since the spring of 1990 there has been a very good cooperation between different churches in several areas. First of all, we started praying together. Pastors meet together for prayer breakfasts. Secondly, we started providing tracks and brochures together and have joint initiatives in the area of evangelism and since 1993 training church planters. We started a Bible school and several publishing houses, which partner in most of the areas. The partnership with Para-church organizations has been a big help in this area. In Partnership with Campus

Crusade for Christ we translated the Jesus film in the beginning of 1990 and started showing it in city cinemas for several years. Then we put it on 16mm and video format and had several campaigns in the country. We are working very well in the area of humanitarian help, human rights and religious freedom and training people in different levels.

B. Describe emerging vital spiritual/ministry initiatives (especially collaborative consortiums)

The Bulgarian Evangelical Alliance has 19 departments, some of them are better functioning, and some are not as well. But all of them are coordinated from Sofia and this helps for the image of the Alliance in society and for better cooperation among churches.

C. List some of the surprising ways God is at work, especially "outside the box"

One of the biggest surprises was the Sofia campaign for showing the Jesus film together with some Orthodox, the Catholics and even secular people in 1999. The Jesus film was shown at over 100 places for 2 weeks. The campaign was under the motto 'Celebrating the Resurrection of Jesus Christ together.' The night before Easter, we closed our campaign by showing the Jesus film on the biggest square in Sofia.

IV. Describe the dreams of Christian leaders in the city as to what they sense God is burdening them to do in the future for His glory (100-150 words).

We dream to have at least 1000 churches in Sofia, each within 5 minutes walking distance from the house of each inhabitant of the city and for each church to become a district center, being actively involved in the social and public life in the region where it is located.

V. Describe the commitments being made among and between the Christian leaders in the city (100-150 words)

These are the commitments that have been made:

- Help and understand one another
- Have agreement on the main issues
- Develop together church leaders and ministers training

- Participate together in the social and political life of the city
- Common social activities
- Common prayers and evangelistic campaigns
- Publish and distribute Bibles and Christian literature together
- Join efforts in the area of prison ministry

The Hope for the Balkans Initiatives in 2002

- A scientific conference with the topic 'The Influence of the Protestant Missionaries for the Spiritual and Political Liberation of the Bulgarian Nation' was organized on March 29 2002.
- Attention to the Society Initiative - April 6 2002 - youth and adults from the Evangelical churches went out to clean and work on the streets of more than 30 cities in the country. During the Days of Christian Mercy in April there were more than 16000 packages provided for the social-care ministries of the churches.
- The Friendship Run - 530 km for 11 days with the ultra-long-distance runner, Stan Cottrell - April 18-28. We were able to have 11 press-conferences with the media in 11 of the larger cities and as a result we saw a wave of positive publications and TV programs in the local media for the life of the Evangelical churches and for the runner himself.

21ST CENTURY REALITIES AND THE DREAMS OF GOD'S SERVANTS

LATIN AMERICA

ARGENTINA
THE WIND OF THE SPIRIT BLOWS IN THE MIDST OF A SECULAR STORM

By: Rino Bello (cch@logos.com.ar) and Hugo Baravalle
ACIERA: Christian Alliance of Evangelical Churches in the Argentine Republic

The World Inquiry was conducted in the cities of Buenos Aires and Rosario by Luis Bush in January 2002 and then facilitated at the Encounter for Pastors for the Evangelization of the Nation (ENPEN) which took place in the city of Mar del Plata April 9 to 12. During two and a half hours Bush, Rino Bello and Jorge Ibarbalz facilitated the World Inquiry among more than 1500 Christian leaders registered for ENPEN who represented the entire country, including the cities, towns and rural areas.

The World Inquiry was very positive and the analysis of the information revealed the challenges the church needs to meet in the power of the Holy Spirit for the evangelization of the nation. The World Inquiry was a valuable instrument for ENPEN where the participants gathered precisely to study the strategies and methodologies for evangelization which the Inquiry helped to clarify.

As a result of the Inquiry in Mar del Plata, various representative leaders from the provinces and cities of Argentina are planning to conduct the survey in their own cities and provinces with whom we are in close contact to assist with the follow-up.

We have no doubt, that in this moment of national crisis in this afflicted nations, God is moving His people in the "supreme task of the church: the evangelization of the world."

I. Argentina's Background in Brief

The deep-rooted effects of the Spanish colonization extend to our present time, and after Argentina's independence in 1810 the Spanish and Italian influx has been even greater.

In the wake of World Wars I and II many European immigrants arrived in the country -in addition to Spaniards and Italians, there came peasants from Russia, Poland, Germany and other Eastern European countries. Because of this blending of races, Argentina became a predominantly European country, both ethnically and culturally.

Until the 1940s, Argentina's stability, economy, educational level, and social welfare conditions positioned the country amongst the world's first seven. A progressive decay settled in and the social and economic conditions in the country, deteriorated in a downhill trend that reaches up to our present time, when

worldwide statistics rank Argentina amongst the under developed countries, in spite of other statistics that still rank the country in certain favorable positions (e.g. the United Nations Economic Development Administration, UNEDA, Human Development Index). {Indice de Desarrollo Humano del PNUD – Programa de Naciones Unidas para el Desarrollo}

The last 30 years have seen a sharp decline, no matter if governments were military or democratic. The country's experience throughout the last 11 years has been this deep and inevitable crisis for which no one seems to find a way out.

Christian sociologist Hilario Wynarczyk puts it this way: "In reality it appears that deregulation, the term used by the theorists of neo liberalism for the elimination of any kind of state controls or regulations upon the market for ideally attaining the much desired free market conditions, has escaped the boundaries of its economic and political application to introduce itself in all social areas.

In Argentina, not only the market but also the opposition, the political parties, the [Roman] Catholic Church and the unions have been steered and regulated by certain actors. Now, the failure of economic deregulation and the reappearance of state controls have also caused the fall of other controls and the paradoxical increase of social deregulation. The hegemonic actors are loosing control as new actors and forms of expression enter the stage.

The "cacerolazos" ["pan beatings"] that have characterized popular discontent amongst Argentineans have given way to a new style of protesting, at a time in which a transition is occurring, from a merciless capitalism to a nationalism that has no idea as to where or what it is heading for. The truth is that the number of poor, jobless and hungered is appallingly on the increase while a host of rich actors do not know how or where to spend their wealth as they make all possible efforts to get their money out of the country.

What could we say regarding the thousands (or millions perhaps) of people, especially youths and professionals, who have decided to leave this country and paradoxically return to the lands of their forefathers?

Undoubtedly, the tunnel is dark and there are those who say they can see a feeble light in the distance - some say it is the exit; others say it is the train coming in the opposite direction…

II. The Evangelical Church in Argentina

The evangelical presence dates back to the colporteurs and the courageous independent missionaries that gave their lives for the sake of the Gospel more than 150 years ago. There were many of them,

and it would be unfair to name some and not others.

The historical churches were the first to settle in the country. The influence of Anglicans and Methodists was great in the early stages of the new country. Other denominations came in during the early 1900's. But the evangelical church really started developing in the 1950's, with the Pentecostal groups taking the lead. The 1970's brought about charismatic renewal movements that resulted in major changes - most of them very positive - within the national leadership.

Throughout the last 20 years, the evangelical leadership affirms expressions of unity, evangelism, discipleship, missions, and more recently of social responsibility. We see the rising of national evangelists, large churches, congresses, conferences, Bible seminaries, specific ministries, etc. In the 1980's the country saw a multiplication of evangelistic crusades throughout the nation and in a diversity of approaches - mass evangelism, one-to-one, through radio, TV, etc. Nevertheless, the 1990's were characterized by a slow-down and it seemed that the church had come to a sort of "plateau," which gave way to less evangelistic activities such as concerts, praise rallies, etc. The 1990's also saw a substantial development of foreign mission work, prompted by a one-equal-to-one exchange rate for dollars-pesos, which lasted 11 years.

Although there is an evangelical presence in every province in Argentina, the same thing cannot be emphatically stated regarding every town or village in the country. One most certainly will find evangelical churches in the big cities, but there are many small—and not so small—towns that have no evangelical witness established there as of yet.

One of the most controversial issues and one that poses many difficulties for reporting exact figures is that of the number of evangelical Christians in the country. Research carried out by reliable ministries shows that evangelicals make up for a 4 to 6 % within a total population of 37 millions.

Others say that the figures should be closer to 8 or 10 %, although this would be the result of including not only church members but also those who could be considered "sympathizers" and those who "at some time - perhaps once only - attended an evangelical church."

The impression a foreign visitor might get is that Argentina has "mega-churches," if we take into account that there are church buildings with a seating capacity for 2,000+ and that these same churches feature up to 3 services every Sunday. On the other hand, it is also true that typical local congregations with an average membership of 200 or 300 members or less have lately experienced a decline in their membership and attendance, due to

a steady exodus of members who emigrate from the country; and this is a serious problem that makes it difficult to provide honest figures.

It is also necessary to take into account the importance of the charismatic movements, which formerly were almost exclusively related to Pentecostal groups and at present are being experienced in many non-Pentecostal denominations. This Evangelical "ecumenism" has undoubtedly done the church at large a lot of good, while at the same time has fostered concern and even ill feelings amongst the traditional groups.

All this strives to put in a nutshell the fact that during the past 20 years the church in Argentina has experienced a "stir of the Spirit" that may well turn into a "revival."

Our reflection at this point is: Is it possible to experience a "revival" if the situation in the country is so difficult? The straightforward answer is, YES, IT IS POSSIBLE!

We believe that the church in Argentina is like the woman ready to give birth described in 2 Kings 19:3: They told him: "This is what Hezekiah says: This day is a day of distress and rebuke and disgrace, as when children come to the point of birth and there is no strength to deliver them." This situation of distress, rebuke and disgrace that was described above in I., we need to recognize and identify as ours, with a humble and repentant heart. Accepting reality means that, knowing our weakness, we might design the best strategies to tackle the task in the most effective manner. In short, let us turn the difficulty into an opportunity, and let us dream!

Let us dream about a Church that has received a visitation of the Holy Spirit and is ready to give birth to a Revival. Today we face a difficult transition point. On one hand, there is toil and pain because the "children come to the point of birth and there is no strength to deliver them," and on the other we have the "children [that have] come to the point of birth." We should like to identify these "children" as the revival that God wants to pour out over Argentina in a way that we have never experienced before, and our present birth pains are a natural part of this process of giving birth. The Argentine church is "pregnant" with God's stir made manifest in these last 20 years, but the children that are coming is something much greater, it is REVIVAL!

Our dream today is to feel pregnant with this vision of revival. For this, we need to strengthen our commitment to:

- The Lord Jesus Christ
- The Church, Christ's body, living out a respectful unity
- Evangelization and discipleship
- Church planting
- Home and foreign missions

- Care programs
- Theological education for ministers
- Penetrating all areas of society, including the political arena

It is possible that at some point in the next 20 years a report be written regarding this time, which will reflect a nation that has emerged from its crisis, with the birds that had to emigrate coming back to their homes here, with Christians serving in key public leadership positions, and more. The church making up for a real 25 to 30 % of the population; missionaries in the most distant locations in the world; evangelists going throughout the nations of the world with the good news. The name that is above all names, JESUS CHRIST, exalted.

All this will come to pass if we are capable of standing our present pain, and if under the power of the Holy Spirit we “push” to deliver the children.

We have described the reality of the secular Argentina, the Church, and the dreams and commitments of the pregnant Church. We bless the church and the nation, in the certainty that the children - revival! - will come, because “there is the sound of a heavy rain":

And Elijah said to Ahab, "Go, eat and drink, for there is the sound of a heavy rain." So Ahab went off to eat and drink, but Elijah climbed to the top of Carmel, bent down to the ground and put his face between his knees. "Go and look toward the sea," he told his servant. And he went up and looked. "There is nothing there," he said. Seven times Elijah said, "Go back." The seventh time the servant reported, "A cloud as small as a man's hand is rising from the sea." So Elijah said, "Go and tell Ahab, ‘Hitch up your chariot and go down before the rain stops you.’ “Meanwhile, the sky grew black with clouds, the wind rose, a heavy rain came on and Ahab rode off to Jezreel. The power of the LORD came upon Elijah and, tucking his cloak into his belt, he ran ahead of Ahab all the way to Jezreel. (I Kings 18:41-46).

World Inquiry for the Cities of Argentina

The Argentine gathering was a great blessing in the midst of a serious national economic, political and social crisis.

Argentine key facilitator for the Bill Kennedy, said: "We have truly lived a miracle of the Lord having received confirmation of over 1500 participants covering the 23 provinces of Argentina and all the major denominations of the 3 mayor umbrella groups. God is turning this into a Historical time. May we all be conscious and ready to be found obedient in all that He gives us through this time, so special for our nation.”

It was called “an encounter of pastors” and was sponsored by CNEC, a new fraternal

entity combining the three major Christian Church leadership structures in the country. The event was hosted at the beautiful three-tiered theatre now church in the costal city of Mar del Plata.

The purpose of this event was to consider the way forward for the evangelization of the country. ENPEN as it became known, provided continuation for the Amsterdam 2000 event led by the Billy Graham Association. As a result of the World Inquires held in January in the city of Buenos Aires and Rosario the national organizing committee included it in the program as they considered it be a useful tool for reflecting together on "where to go from here in the evangelization of Argentina."

The interest in ENPEN exceeded early expectations of the organizers. Actually not many weeks prior to the event CNEC seriously considered canceling the gathering as there were less than 100 people registered. However the problem became providing transportation. World Help, an organization based in Virginia led by Vernon Brewer who is partnering with the World Inquiry, came through with funds for ten buses. According to Ruben Proietti, a key leader of CNEC, the timing was such that it opened the gates for others who were waiting to see what would happen.

By the beginning of the first morning of the conference, about 1500 key pastors, denominational, mission, lay and women leaders registered for ENPEN from all of the 23 provinces. From the beginning of our time together there was a powerful sense of the presence of the Lord. On the first morning of the conference, following the devotional, two and one half hours were set aside for the World Inquiry in the plenary session. The actual facilitation of the Inquiry was conducted by two of the members of the organizing committee. They encouraged the leaders from the cities to return and organize a world inquiry with Christian leaders in their own city.

The compilation of the results of the focus group meetings by city provided a significant picture by city and for the entire nation of what the servants of the Lord are sensing in their spirits God is saying at this time.

ECUADORIAN EVANGELICAL CHURCH TOWARD A HOLISTIC EVANGELIZATION PLAN
QUITO, ECUADOR

Estuardo Lopez, President of the Ecuadorian Evangelical Confraternity (ceequito@uio.telconet.net) and Jim Estes, HCJB Regional Director for Latin America (jestes@hcjb.org.ec.)

The Ecuadorian Evangelical Confraternity (C.E.E.) has been working since 1964 to build unity in the Ecuadorian evangelical Church and present the challenge that evangelization should be holistic and contextual based on the values and biblical principles that have been the characteristic of evangelicals through the centuries.

In May 1999, with the approach of the twenty first century and with the purpose of establishing a vision and for evangelicals for the third millennium, the C.E.E. convened an Evangelical Summit with the participation of three hundred pastors and leaders representing form all over the county. In that event emphasis was made on the urgency to share the Gospel of salvation in Jesus Christ and the need to discover appropriate common action-areas for the coming years in which to implement a holistic and conceptualized evangelization approach.

With the participation and insights of about 1800 national pastors and leaders a strategic plan to 2006 was elaborated with the following five action-areas.

1. Evangelization and missions. This involves the embracing of the message of the Kingdom of God as the framework and practice for local and national evangelization as well as cross-cultural missions. Evangelization is defined as follows: "Evangelism involves the proclamation of the message of the Christ of History and the Bible as Lord and Savior, with the purpose of persuading others, in the power and with the wisdom of the Holy Spirit, to come to him personally and be reconciled to God."

   By means of different evangelism projects we commit to evangelize the "whole country" with the "whole Gospel" and collaborate actively in world evangelization. The project: "Te bendecimos Quito," "We bless you Quito," is the first project with the participation of sixty churches in and surrounding Quito over a thee-year period. Other cities including Loja and Riobamba have also implemented "We bless you" initiatives, with the invitation to

implement this project on a country-wide basis under the name “We bless you Ecuador.”

2. Discipleship and responsibility. We seek to promote a nation-wide discipleship process by promoting teaching on the Kingdom of God in society, church and family. Although the number of evangelical Christians grows (estimated at 7% of the population), the lack of biblical discipleship and responsibility of believers calls for fostering this “line of action.”

3. Christian service. This area calls for the collaborating of churches, organizations and evangelical ministries together in a serving both church and community. This calls for services for the poor and the dispossessed families, children, youth, elderly and ethnic peoples.

4. The formation of transformational leadership. The creation of training for pastors by means of contextualized programs promoted by the churches, schools, seminaries and evangelical universities. The Ecuadorian society cries out for the cultivation of ethical values and morals in the midst of increasing corruption at all levels.

5. Evangelical unity and identity. The “line of action” deals with the problem of unity and seeks biblical and doctrinal basis among the leadership. This includes an analysis of the identity of the Ecuadorian Protestants (historical legacy) to develop a common prophetic voice for the nation. In the same way, we seek to build a significant unity in the church in its multiple expressions as the body of Christ in the nation. In order to do that we call upon the consolidation of the C.E.E. and pastoral bodies, Christian organizations and the promotion of unity in Spirit and action.

For further information contact Estuardo Lopez, President of the Ecuadorian Evangelical Confraternity, ceequito@uio.telconet.net or Jim Estes, HCJB Regional Director for Latin America, jestes@hcjb.org.ec.

APPENDIX A

World Inquiry
Meta-Narrative Form

Country Name: _____ Province Name: _____
City-Name: _____ Date: _____

Name of Person Writing Draft of Meta-Narrative for the City: _____

The narrative survey is limited to 900 words. It is in the form of newspaper headings with some support detail to further describe each heading.

I. Describe the realities of the city at the beginning of the 21st century with a brief hi-level perspective of the history and characteristics of the city (100-150 words)

II. What are the realities of the church and mission of God's people in the city at the beginning of the 21st century with a brief hi-level perspective of the history and characteristics of the Church/mission of God's people in that city? (100-150 words)
   A. The realities including history and characteristics of the Church in that city
   B. The realities including history and characteristics of the mission of God's people in that city (mission in the city, mission in the country and missions to the world)

III. What are the vital spiritual/ministry initiatives with special focus on the "new things" God is doing in and through His people in the city? Describe any collaborative consortium that is interdependent without losing the autonomy and distinctiveness of any of the cooperating partners. (200-250 words)
   A. Existing vital spiritual/ministry initiatives (especially collaborative consortiums)
   B. Describe emerging vital spiritual/ministry initiatives (especially collaborative consortiums)
   C. List some of the surprising ways God is at work, especially "outside the box"

IV. Describe the dreams of Christian leaders in the city as to what they sense God is burdening them to do in the future for His glory (100-150 words)

V. Describe the commitments being made among and between the Christian leaders in the city (100-150 words)

VI. Stories of God at work in and through individuals and ministries and coalitions God is using in the city.